
MH@MERICS · WEEK 26 · 2026

Weekly Update

22 – 28 Jun 2026

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I. Highlights

Spotlight 1: EU-China launch Trade and Investment Consultations; October deadline for “first tangible results”

Šefčovič and Wang Wentao met in Brussels on **29 June** and issued the **first joint EU-China trade statement since 2019**. The two sides launched the **Trade and Investment Consultations (TIC)** mechanism with four workstreams — **(1) trade and investment balancing, (2) export controls, (3) intellectual property rights, (4) WTO reform** — and committed to a follow-up at ministerial level in **Autumn 2026**.

Šefčovič set an **October deadline** for “first tangible results” and will travel to Beijing then. A roadmap of expected deliverables is due in the coming days; a first assessment of progress is scheduled for **September**. Asked what happens if China does not deliver, he deflected: “I like to focus on the positive... I see much more understanding for the common challenges and the European situation from our Chinese counterparts.”

A **joint monitoring mechanism on trade flows** is the most operational element: both sides will work from a shared dataset, and import spikes “crossing into yellow and red zones” will trigger automatic escalation — “discussion will immediately jump to political level,” Šefčovič said.

Šefčovič framed the meeting as “intensive, focused and constructive” with “much more convergence on how we perceive the mutual challenges,” while underlining that “the trend is not sustainable, and the status quo is not an option” and that the EU “simply cannot afford to continue” like this.

One concrete Chinese concession: Wang assured that PRC export controls on rare earths and permanent magnets “will not disrupt EU supply chains”; Šefčovič proposed new licensing-facilitation arrangements for EU companies.

What is actually new vs spin: the TIC platform itself (first joint statement since 2019; structured 4-workstream mandate; joint data feed with trigger thresholds; October hard date) — not a deliverable on the underlying imbalance. Šefčovič conceded “not everything will be solved by October” but framed the process as enough “to see the direction of travel.”

Sources: [EC joint statement](#) · [Politico \(Martuscelli\)](#) · [Birmingham/SCMP thread](#) · [Liboreiro/Euronews thread](#).

German China policy in context

GERMANY

- **Chancellor Merz took three China-related questions in his Bundestag Regierungsbefragung on 24 June** – Roloff (SPD) pressed on the **Industrial Accelerator Act** and a binding “**Buy European**” procurement preference against subsidised Chinese supply, with a follow-up on the **International Procurement Instrument**. Merz framed the issue as “makroökonomische Ungleichgewichte” (macroeconomic imbalances) from the June European Council, said the Commission’s proposals would come back to the **October Council for decision**, and named “subsidies, massive overcapacities and above all distortions through artificially suppressed currencies” as the unfair part of competition to act against – “auf der Basis von Reziprozität” (on the basis of reciprocity), but only in lockstep with European partners (“ich möchte nicht, dass wir hier in Deutschland alleine Entscheidungen treffen” / “I don’t want Germany to take decisions on its own here”). Hardt (CDU/CSU) on G7 Evian leverage via India and Brazil on Russia. Schätzl (SPD) on Chinese components in **5G/6G** and telco reciprocity, with a sharp follow-up that the **Chinese-vendor share is over 60%** and drone defence is meant to run via the mobile network – Merz reiterated that European telcos have “praktisch keinen Zugang” (“practically no access”) to networks in that country and that the **Nationaler Sicherheitsrat (National Security Council) is developing a comprehensive infrastructure security strategy** with AA, BMVg and BMI in which this will “play a prominent role.”
- **The federal government suspended the CISA Helmholtz-Centre director and ordered an external review** after Handelsblatt exposed deep cooperation between the Saarbrücken cybersecurity institute and Chinese researchers with PLA-adjacent ties – making CISA the most prominent case yet in the widening debate over Chinese access to German strategic research (Jun 24). *Update Jun 29: BMBF appointed Alexander Geschonneck (KPMG, Global Head of Forensic, previously special investigator on Wirecard) as Sonderprüfer; audit began Mon 23 Jun, remit = clarify whether sensitive AI/cybersecurity know-how flowed from CISA to China; Backes remains suspended for the duration.*
- **Volkswagen’s management proposed up to 60,000 additional job cuts**, with tagesschau reporting board-level plans for up to 100,000 – formalising the restructuring response to VW’s China sales collapse and pricing in a structurally weaker China business (FAZ, Jun 22).
- **Economy Minister Reiche met Chinese Commerce Minister Wang Wentao in Brussels on 28 June** – both sides agreed to fast-track reactivation of the bilateral **Joint Economic Committee** (originally agreed during Reiche’s May visit to Beijing). Reiche pitched German Außenwirtschaftspolitik as “pragmatic” – pursuing mutual interests while insisting on “fairness, open markets, level competitive conditions, reliable supply chains, and balanced trade.” The meeting took place a day before Wang’s parallel Sefčovič talks on 29 June.

EU INSTITUTIONAL

- **Beijing’s pre-talks posture and the EU toolkit Šefčovič brought into the room** (see Spotlight 1 for the outcome). A CCTV-affiliated Yuyuantan commentary – read in Beijing as an official signal – framed China as “ready to withstand further deterioration in economic and trade ties, even a freeze,” arguing Chinese firms no longer treat any single market as essential and can pivot to Southeast Asia, the Middle East and Latin America. Beijing’s substantive asks on the table: price-undertaking solutions on the EU’s EV anti-subsidy duties, and easing of European export-control restrictions on high-tech items going to China; MOFCOM has separately warned of “resolute countermeasures” against new EU restrictions. Šefčovič entered hobbled by member-state flip-flopping (Spain courting Chinese investment, others wavering) but armed with a 19 June Council mandate on a “diversification instrument” (≥ 3 suppliers for critical inputs) and a still-undeployed Anti-Coercion Instrument.
- **DG ENV reported tangible progress in the EU-China dialogue on biodiversity and plastics** – a rare cooperative track holding up while the trade and security frames harden (Jun 24).
- **The EU signed the US-led “Pax Silica” declaration singling out China on AI chips** – Euractiv quotes experts warning the alignment “comes at the cost of AI independence” for Europe, sharpening the trade-off between transatlantic AI security and European technological sovereignty.
- **The new EU FDI-screening Regulation 2026/1386 was published in the Official Journal on 24 June (applies from January 2028)** – it replaces the 2019 voluntary cooperation framework with a

binding harmonised screening regime across all 27 member states. Mandatory minimum coverage spans eight critical sectors (semiconductors, quantum, AI, dual-use goods, strategic raw materials, critical infrastructure, financial-market entities, voter-registration systems), and the regulation closes the prior loophole that let third-country investors – including Chinese ones – acquire sensitive EU assets through EU-established subsidiaries without triggering FDI screening.

EU MEMBER STATES

- **Taiwanese semiconductor and EV firms are setting up production in Poland** to substitute for Chinese (and US) suppliers in EU supply chains – a concrete substitution dynamic in the EU's eastern neighbourhood that doubles as a Taiwan-Europe industrial-policy bridge ([The Diplomat](#)).

MERICS

MERICS RESEARCH AND (MEDIA) INSIGHTS

China's transnational interference threatens digital rights globally. Daria Impiombato and Wendy Chang on Beijing's coercive use of digital tools across borders, with a call for Europe to harden defences. (*Comment, Jun 26*)

Xi visits Pyongyang and China rehabilitates North Korea. Andrew Scobell (MERICS Senior Fellow): Russia's renewed standing in northeast Asia and continued US strength in the region have encouraged Beijing to set aside reservations about its only official ally. (*Comment, Jun 24*)

The EU Must Confront China's Trade Challenge. Grzegorz Stec lays out why the EU must urgently move beyond defensive instruments. (*Wire China opinion, Jun 25*)

The China deficit Brussels can no longer ignore. Issue 253 | In collaboration with Mercator Institute for China Studies (MERICS) – Germany drove most of the EU's larger China deficit in April. (*Soapbox, Jun 22*)

SELECTED INSIGHTS FOR MEDIA BY COLLEAGUES

Wendy Chang quoted by **BBC Chinese** on a surge of China's chip exports and export restrictions.

Top charts and visuals W26

Chart 1 – For every US\$100 China exported at the start of the Xi era, it now exports almost US\$200; for every US\$100 imported, just US\$164 (Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 254 – Jun 29 2026; Chinese exports vs imports indexed to 2013 = 100, 2013–2025).



Chart 2 – China’s exports rose US\$230 bn YoY in Jan–May 2026; the US bucket fell US\$5 bn while the EU absorbed +US\$36 bn – ASEAN +US\$50 bn, HK +US\$55 bn
(Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 254; change in Chinese exports by destination, J–M 2026 vs J–M 2025, US\$ bn).

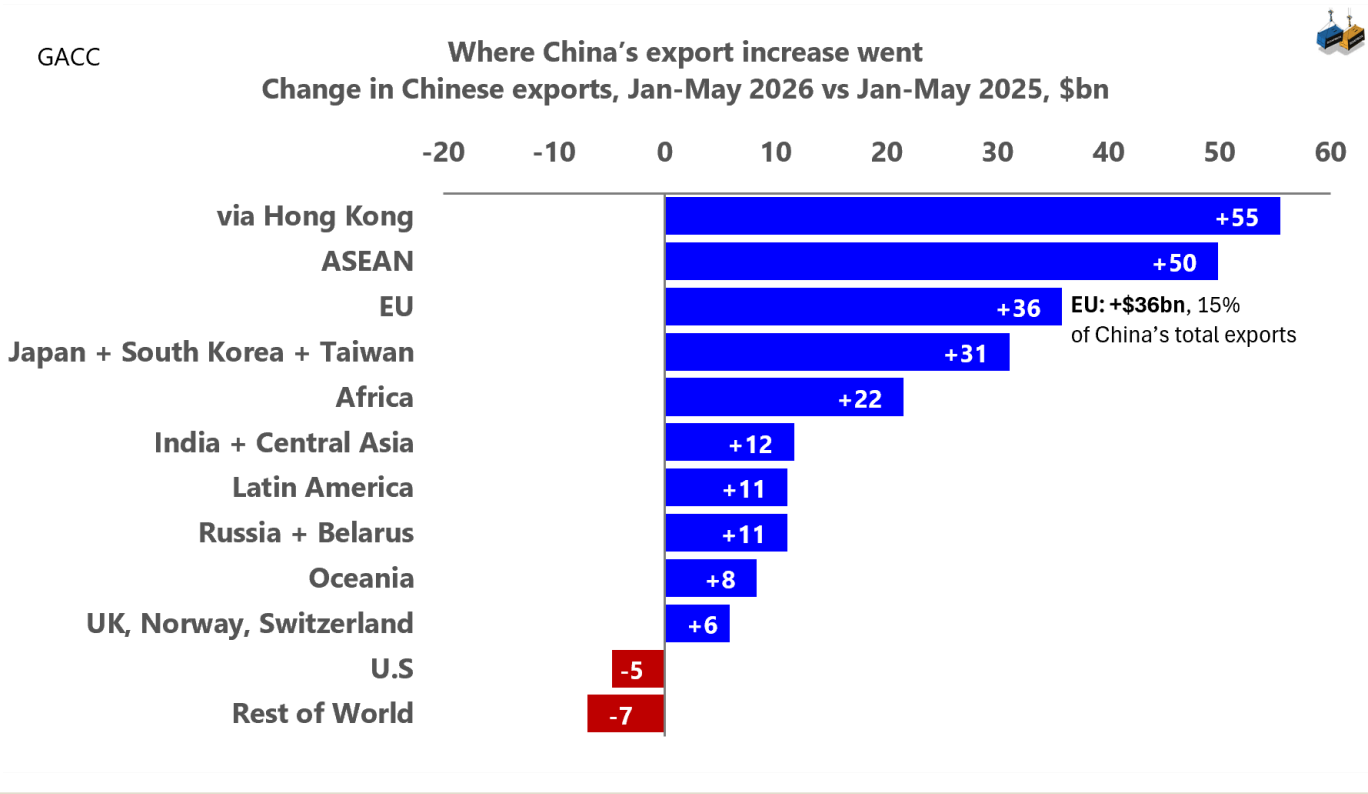


Chart 3 – Under the EU’s new dedicated solar-inverter customs code (CN85044084), China accounts for virtually 100% of EU import value (Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 254; EU solar-inverter imports by origin, % share, 2026 YTD).

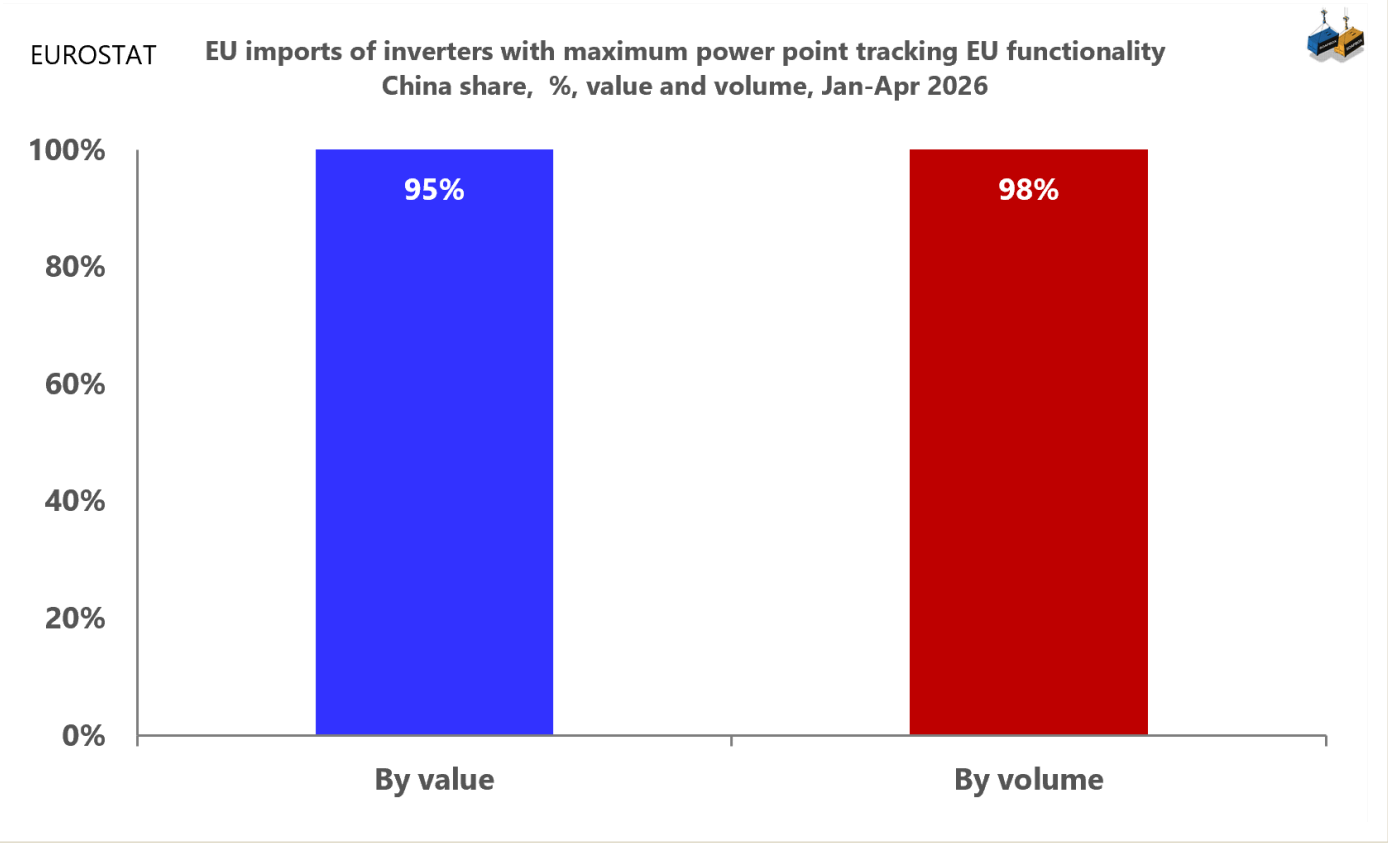
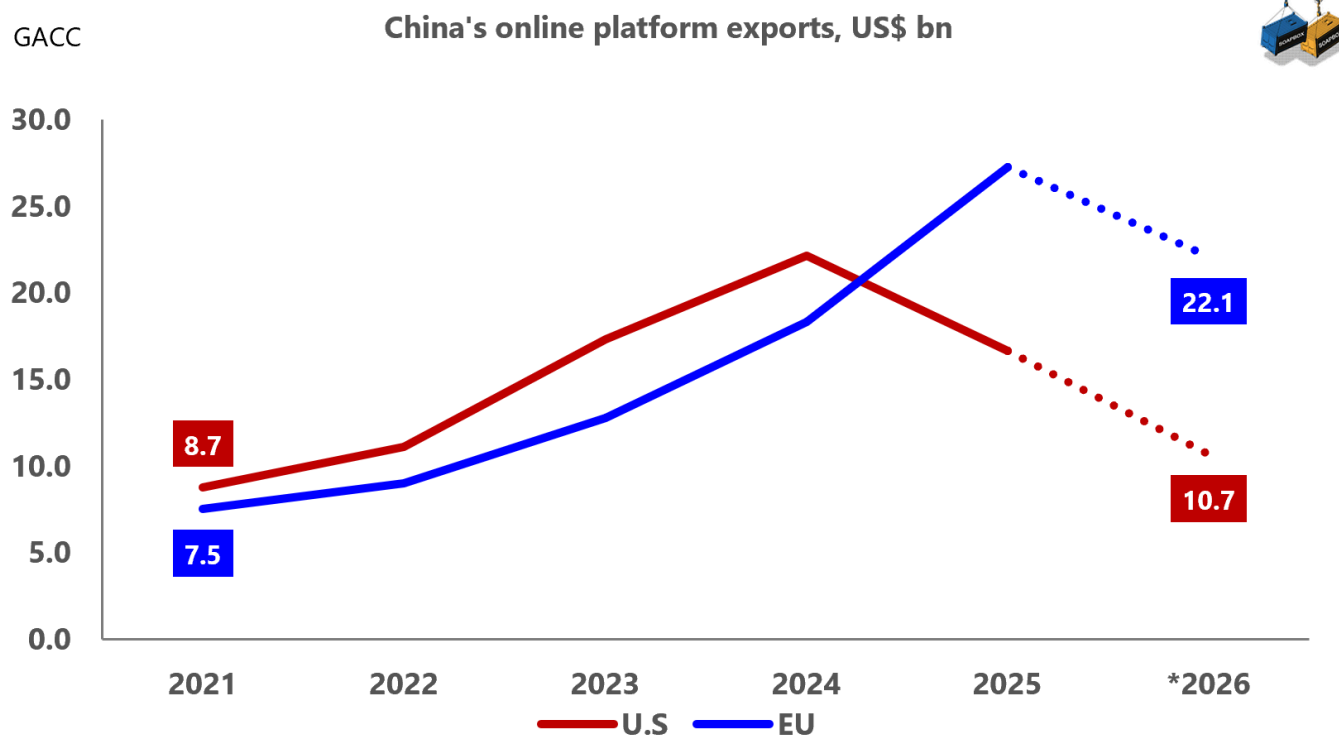


Chart 4 – China-to-EU parcels overtook China-to-US parcels in 2025; EU remained the larger destination even ahead of the 1 July de-minimis tightening (Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 254; China-origin small parcels by destination, monthly, 2024–2026).



*2026 annualised from Jan-May China Customs data. SOAPBOX estimate.

Chart 5 – Hybrids' share of China's electric+hybrid car exports rose from 41% to 48.7%; pure-EV share fell from 59% to 51.3% (Jan–May 2026 vs Jan–May 2025) (Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 254; China NEV exports, EV vs hybrid mix, % share, J–M 2025 vs J–M 2026).

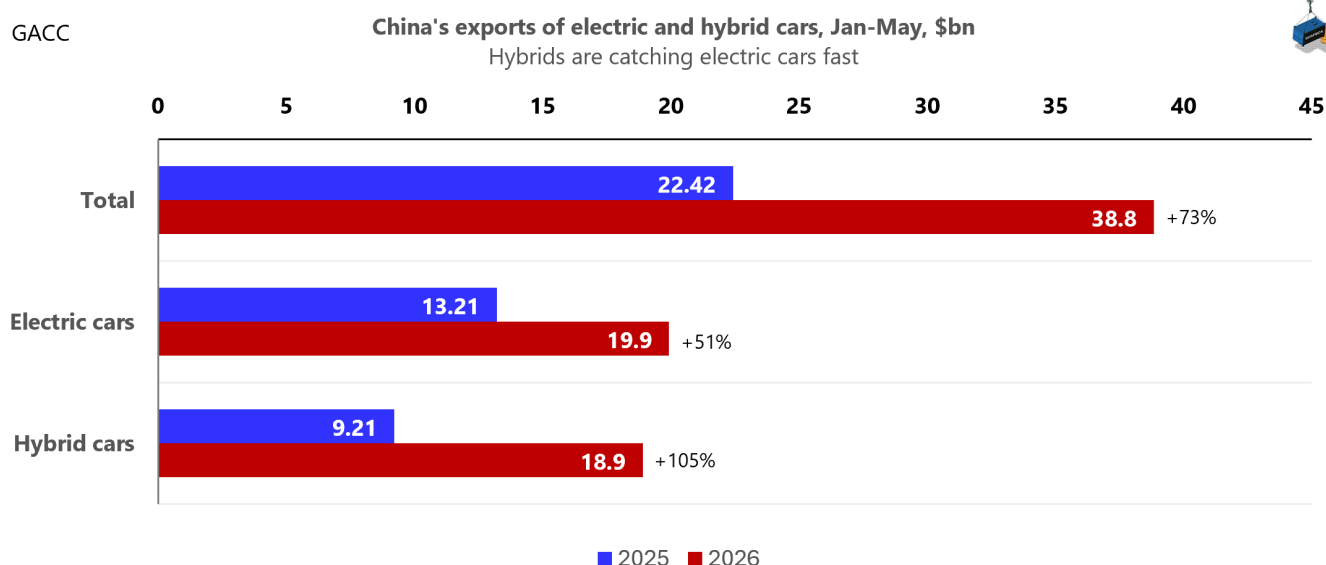
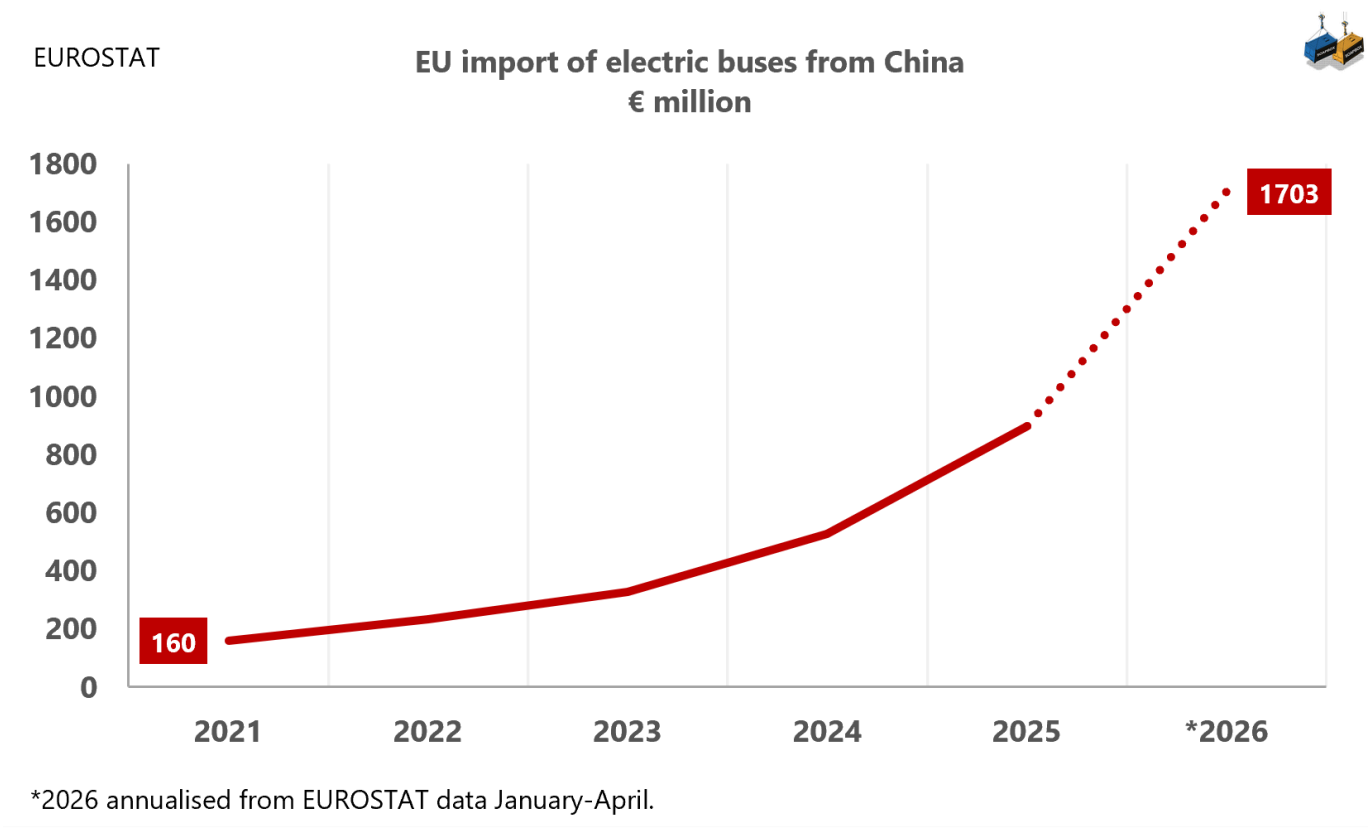


Chart 6 – EU imports of Chinese electric buses jumped from €160 million (2021) to a projected €1.7 billion in 2026 – a ten-fold rise in five years (Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 254; EU imports of electric buses from China, € million, 2021–2026 annualised).



III. International

1. Domestic economic situation and policy

BLOOMBERG · 25 JUN 2026

Six Charts That Explain China's Weakening Economy

- **2026 growth target set at 4.5–5% – the least ambitious since 1991:** Property prices have fallen ~30% from their 2021 peak; real estate's share of GDP collapsed from ~25% to under 20%. Deflation has persisted since 2023, with Beijing officially flagging “involution” (内卷) destructive price wars as a top-priority drag across EVs, food delivery and other sectors.
 - **Demographic crunch deepens:** 2025 births fell to 7.93 million (lowest since 1949) – the tenth straight annual decline. Working-age share is down to ~61% (vs >70% a decade ago); the worker-to-pensioner ratio (currently ~4:1) is projected to halve within 20 years. Bloomberg notes Beijing is betting on AI, semis, biotech and robotics productivity to offset the demographic drag.
 - **Exports are the offset – but increasingly contested:** Net exports = ~one-third of 2025 GDP growth (highest share since 1997); record **\$1.2 trillion trade surplus** held up despite US tariffs reaching 145% early 2025, absorbed largely by Europe + Southeast Asia. To hit Xi's “moderately developed economy by 2035” target, China needs ~4.17% average annual growth – but a growing number of countries (not only the US) are imposing tariffs/quotas on Chinese imports.
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CAIXIN · 24 JUN 2026

China Auditor Exposes Local Governments Faking Debt Cleanups

- **National Audit Office found local governments deleting debt records to fake compliance:** Multiple provinces artificially reduced reported hidden debt balances, including by removing entries from the official debt management system.
 - **17 counties inflated project returns to secure 12.2 billion yuan in special-purpose bond proceeds:** Some regions then misused the funds for unauthorised expenses including government buildings and corporate loan repayments.
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CAIXIN · 26 JUN 2026

China Audit Reveals Billions of Rural Funds Diverted for Local Debt

- **Local governments misappropriated 28 billion yuan in agricultural funds:** Dozens of counties diverted rural program money to service local debts, prop up state-owned enterprises, and cover administrative costs.
 - **State Council audit report presented to NPC Standing Committee:** Auditor General Hou Kai delivered findings on 2025 central budget execution to the 14th NPC Standing Committee on June 23.
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China to roll out nursing care insurance nationwide as population ages

- **China to extend nursing care insurance nationwide by end of 2028:** The program aims to spread long-term care costs across generations as over 10% of the rapidly growing elderly population requires nursing care.
 - **Regional disparities and local government finances cited as lingering concerns:** Uneven coverage across provinces and strained local budgets are identified as the main risks for the planned nationwide rollout.
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Robot nation: China's bid to beat its demographic decline

- **China's working-age population set to shrink 70% by 2100:** The UN projection - a fall from 1bn to 300mn - underpins Beijing's push to embed AI-controlled robots across manufacturing and services to offset demographic decline, the FT reports.
 - **China dominates global humanoid shipments with 90% market share:** Beijing set a 10,000-unit commercial deployment target for 2025 and backs robotics through a Rmb1tn 20-year technology fund under its "new productive forces" agenda.
 - **Automation is spreading from factories into service industries:** Huazhu Hotels cut its staff-to-room ratio to 0.1 - against an industry benchmark of 0.3-0.8 - and a ceramics firm reduced headcount by 40% while raising output 32%.
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Robots will replace 700,000 delivery workers 'sooner or later', warns JD.com boss

- **JD.com's Liu warns robots will replace 700,000 couriers:** Speaking at APEC's CEO forum, he said robot delivery is inevitable and that JD.com has contracted 120 schools to retrain staff.
 - **China's gig workforce expected to reach 320 million in 2026:** Up from 200 million five years ago, they represent about 40 per cent of urban employment, according to industry data.
 - **China's five-year plan makes robotics a core industrial driver:** The IFR said Beijing is pivoting AI research towards physical applications, with robots as the main engine of economic growth.
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China pays price for 'Ponzi scheme'-driven property boom

- **Pan Shiyi labeled China's property model a "Ponzi scheme":** The former industry heavyweight argued in an April social media post that the investment model fueled a property bubble, stressing "restoration of trust."
 - **The post was deleted but copies spread widely, sparking public debate:** Nikkei reports the content circulated online despite removal soon after publication, drawing broad public discussion in China.
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Chinese Steel Market Enters Long Plateau After Property Crash

- **China's overall steel demand held within 3.1% of its 2020 peak:** Manufacturing, shipbuilding, and the energy transition absorbed most of the 83 million tonnes of rebar demand lost from the property sector, according to industry analysts at Singapore International Ferrous Week.
 - **Record exports of 119 million tonnes cushioned mills as trade patterns shifted:** Africa shipments rose 30% while North America fell nearly 20% in 2025, as traditional buyers imposed duties on Chinese steel.
 - **CISA criticised the EU's carbon border levy as "grossly unfair" to Chinese producers:** The association cited more than 300 billion yuan invested in environmental upgrades and 932 million tonnes of capacity retrofitted to ultra-low-emissions standards.
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China Lays Out Blueprint to Boost Consumption of Clean Energy

- **China mandates binding renewable consumption targets from August 2026:** The NDRC order requires companies and provinces to meet quarterly monitored quotas for the share of electricity and non-electric energy drawn from renewable sources.
 - **Policy shift addresses rising curtailment as new capacity additions slow:** Beijing is reorienting its energy transition from building renewables to ensuring their utilisation, as new pricing rules have reduced solar and wind farm revenue.
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China's 618 shopping festival sees flat e-commerce sales as shoppers remain cautious

- **618 festival GMV nearly flat at 863.6 billion yuan:** Syntun's 37-day measure shows total e-commerce sales up less than 1% from last year's 855.6 billion yuan, reflecting broad consumer caution.
- **Chinese retail sales fell 0.6% year-on-year in May:** Reuters reports this as the first monthly retail decline since December 2022, when China was still under COVID-era restrictions.

2. Politics and society

Inside China's ideological training camp where PLA top brass study Xi's speeches

- **Xi personally ordered a 10-week ideological training camp for hundreds of PLA senior officers:** Participants studied Xi's speeches, reviewed corrupt cadres' confessions, and practised military drills, according to PLA Daily.
 - **The exercise targeted loyalty and anti-corruption norms amid a sweeping military graft drive:** Five of seven Central Military Commission members named in 2022 have since been removed, with Xi stressing the anti-corruption campaign will not stop.
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CAIXIN · 25 JUN 2026

China's Anti-Corruption Drive Sweeps Up Senior Defense and Space Official

- **CCDI placed SASTIND deputy head Bian Zhigang under investigation:** The Central Commission for Discipline Inspection announced the probe on June 25 for suspected serious violations of Party discipline and law.
 - **Bian's case brings 2026 centrally managed cadres under investigation to 35:** He held concurrent roles overseeing national defense science and technology as well as China's lunar exploration programme under CNSA.
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SCMP · 26 JUN 2026

China removes 6 generals from legislature as military anti-corruption drive continues

- **NPC Standing Committee stripped six PLA generals of their legislative seats:** Removal codifies the corruption probes that have swept the PLA Rocket Force, Strategic Support Force and Equipment Development Department over the past two years.
 - **Xi's anti-graft drive in the military shows no sign of slowing:** The article ties the latest move to the broader pattern of high-level PLA purges since 2023, including the loss of multiple Central Military Commission members.
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CAIXIN · 25 JUN 2026

Ex-Mainland Official's Son Convicted of Money-Laundering in Hong Kong

- **Hong Kong court convicts son of Wuhan anti-graft official:** Xiao Rui was found guilty of four money-laundering counts, with more than HK\$64 million laundered on his father's behalf.
 - **Mainland bribes funnelled into Hong Kong via underground financial networks:** The conviction illustrates how illicit funds are channelled through informal networks into the city's banking system, according to Caixin.
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SCMP · 21 JUN 2026

How 'lying flat' went from a niche subculture to mainstream phenomenon

- **Ministry of State Security blamed foreign forces for "lying flat":** China's spy agency accused unnamed overseas groups of funding influencers to conduct "lying flat brainwashing" targeting young Chinese, according to SCMP.
 - **"Lying flat" has expanded from fringe subculture to mainstream phenomenon:** The trend now encompasses professionals, entrepreneurs, and officials who reduce effort amid intensifying competition with diminishing returns, the article reports.
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China Targets Drug-Laced E-Cigarettes Amid Surge in Youth Addiction

- **"Heady e-cigarettes" become the primary drug-abuse method among Chinese youth:** Vape pens containing the anesthetic etomidate are proliferating rapidly among teenagers, with synthetic substances now outpacing heroin in popularity, according to Caixin.
 - **Supreme People's Court publishes criminal cases on new-type narcotics:** The court issued a stark warning highlighting the threat disguised narcotics pose to minors as authorities intensify enforcement against the substances.
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As More Chinese Own Pets, Young People Stand Up for Animal Welfare

- **Chongqing police dispersed a days-long animal-abuse sit-in:** Officers detained more than ten demonstrators and erected metal barricades four days after residents gathered outside the accused abuser's apartment.
 - **Absent cruelty laws cap the suspect's charge at 15 days' detention:** China's livestock industry - \$520 billion in output and 11 million jobs - is the primary barrier to animal protection legislation, legal experts say.
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China Proposes New Rules for Booming Micro-Drama Industry

- **China's broadcasting regulator proposes first micro-drama industry rules:** The draft introduces a three-tier content management system and prohibits material promoting money worship, according to Caixin.
 - **Heavy investment and AI adoption have driven rapid sector growth:** The regulations aim to standardize an entertainment industry in which AI-generated content production has proliferated, the article reports.
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In China, some researchers are attending academic conferences that do not exist

- **Fake conferences promise indexed publications for a fee:** A Wuhan lecturer paid 4,600 yuan (\$680) for a submission that appeared in an obscure, unrecognised journal - the conference itself had never taken place.
 - **Professional title requirements drive demand for bogus academic events:** Chinese researchers needing conference publications for career advancement are targeted by scammers fabricating entire events, committees, and indexing credentials, according to SCMP.
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FT · 26 JUN 2026

Small plane crashes into Beijing's tallest building

- **Small propeller aircraft hit Beijing's Citic Tower on Friday:** A Sunward SA60L from Eastern Pioneer flying school struck the 528-metre skyscraper's upper floors, with debris falling in the central business district.
 - **Chinese state media and social media censored all coverage of the crash:** Police sealed the area and blocked photography, while Beijing's foreign ministry did not respond to requests for comment.
 - **Ex-CIA China chief forecast a cover-up and official dismissals:** Dennis Wilder said Xi would "presume the worst" given the flight's proximity to the Zhongnanhai leadership compound.
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NYT · 22 JUN 2026

With No Team in the World Cup, China's Fans Celebrate a Referee

- **Chinese referee breaks 24-year World Cup officiating gap:** Ma Ning led the first all-Chinese refereeing team at the 2026 tournament, 24 years after China's last and only World Cup appearance.
- **Ma Ning landed Meituan and Castrol endorsement deals:** He also amassed over 480,000 combined followers on Weibo and Rednote since his World Cup selection.

3a. Geoeconomics – tech & innovation

ECONOMIST · 21 JUN 2026

The Economist: China is having another AI moment

- **Zhipu's GLM 5.2 ranked most capable open-source AI model:** Artificial Analysis placed it fourth overall behind ChatGPT 5.5, priced at under one-tenth of Anthropic's Fable 5, with weights publicly released.
 - **Private benchmarks put America's true AI lead at 8-10 months:** Norwegian Defence Research Establishment analysis found the gap nearly doubles compared to the 4-6 month lag apparent on public benchmark tests, where Chinese models show signs of "teaching to the test".
 - **Chinese models' cost advantage undercut by higher token consumption:** A Georgia Tech study found DeepSeek used 23 times more tokens than its OpenAI rival for equivalent tasks, making total costs comparable or higher than American systems.
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NYT · 26 JUN 2026

Chinese A.I. Models Close the Gap With Anthropic and OpenAI

- **Z.ai's GLM-5.2 enters US market as Anthropic's top models face government restrictions:** Six of the models currently ranked on the AI leaderboard were developed in China, the article reports.
 - **Low cost is winning US converts despite security and IP concerns:** US businesses are switching to Chinese AI models amid worries about government ties and allegations of unfair use of American technology to build cheaper systems.
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Chinese Hedge Funds Warn the AI 'Super Bubble' Is Ready to Burst

- **Two prominent Chinese hedge funds warn of AI super bubble:** Wealspring Asset and Shanghai Banxia each issued investor letters calling the global AI stock rally unsustainable, with Wealspring warning the “collapse point may not be far away.”
 - **Banxia cites Anthropic revenue pressure as the bubble's trigger:** The \$294 million fund predicted Anthropic’s annualized revenue run-rate will fall short of market expectations as token costs rise and developer competition intensifies.
 - **Wealspring warns some Chinese AI stocks could crash over 80%:** The \$1.4 billion fund said many domestic AI infrastructure companies lack durable competitive advantages and require constant capital spending to sustain growth.
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Anthropic accuses Alibaba of obtaining illicit access to Claude

- **Alibaba used 25,000 fake accounts to extract Claude outputs:** Anthropic’s June 10 Senate Banking Committee letter reported 28.8 million exchanges targeting agentic reasoning, software engineering, and long-horizon task capabilities.
 - **Anthropic urged Congress to penalise PRC distillation attacks:** The letter called for penalties against Chinese AI labs and closure of loopholes allowing PRC access to advanced US chips.
 - **National security concerns focus on Claude's cyber-offensive model:** Anthropic’s Mythos model - which the US government has deployed in cyber operations against China - was among the capabilities allegedly targeted.
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Anthropic Claims Alibaba Ran 'Brazen' Campaign to Access Its Claude AI Model

- **Anthropic accused Alibaba of the largest known distillation attack:** The company alleged 25,000 fake accounts conducted ~28.8 million Claude exchanges (April 22 – June 5), targeting agentic reasoning and software engineering capabilities.
 - **Anthropic called for anti-distillation legislation and tighter chip controls:** The company told senators distillation turns “billions in American R&D into a massive subsidy for geopolitical competitors,” per WSJ.
 - **Chinese AI models are closing the performance gap with US counterparts:** Zhipu AI ranks fourth and Alibaba’s Qwen 3.7 Max eighth globally, according to the Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index.
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DeepSeek Looks to Double Workforce as Fresh Funding Fuels Growth

- **DeepSeek raised \$7.4 billion in its first funding round, valuing it above \$50 billion:** Founder Liang Wenfeng [梁文峰] contributed ~20 bn yuan (~\$2.8 bn), with Tencent and China’s National AI Industry Investment Fund among additional investors.
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DeepSeek plans hiring spree in escalation of China's AI talent war

- **DeepSeek launches hiring drive to double team sizes:** The company is broadening from frontier model research into product development, advertising roles in law, medicine, and language, the FT reports.
 - **DeepSeek seeks outside investment for the first time:** The fundraising is partly motivated by staff poaching by larger rivals including ByteDance and Xiaomi, according to people familiar with the matter.
 - **DeepSeek and Huawei are collaborating on Ascend chip optimisation:** The partnership supports Beijing's push to reduce AI hardware reliance on Nvidia, though adapting frontier models to domestic chips has posed engineering challenges.
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Opinion: ByteDance sidelines listing as China's first \$1 trillion valuation nears

- **ByteDance board decided against listing in early May:** Directors concluded that delaying an IPO is preferable given grey-market valuations above \$600 billion and expectations of further appreciation, according to two people familiar with the matter.
 - **Doubao AI chatbot - ByteDance's largest by monthly active users - is introducing paid tiers:** Morgan Stanley analysts describe the move as a broader industry shift from user subsidies toward commercial sustainability.
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World's fastest supercomputer is now from China, surpassing US and Germany

- **China's LineShine reclaims Top500 No. 1 – first time since 2017:** US El Capitan slips to 2nd; Germany's Jupiter holds 5th; Frontier (US) drops further down the list – the European-perspective angle Euronews foregrounds.
 - **Result reframes the export-control debate:** Achievement comes despite the US chip-control regime, raising questions whether the Chinese domestic semiconductor stack is closing the performance gap faster than expected.
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China Takes Supercomputer Crown From U.S. for First Time Since 2017

- **China's LineShine supercomputer reclaims world No. 1 ranking after nine years:** The Shenzhen system outperformed the US El Capitan machine by 21.5% (≈ 2.2 EF vs ≈ 1.7 EF) on the Top500 benchmark, per NYT.
 - **CPU-only design identified as loophole in US chip export controls:** LineShine uses Armv9.2-LX2 CPUs with SVE2 vector + SME matrix-math units and is fully CPU-only (no GPUs) – sidestepping the Nvidia-GPU export restrictions, which experts told the NYT represents a regulatory gap Washington should close.
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Chinese Supercomputer Overtakes U.S. as World's Fastest

- **LineShine claims the No. 1 spot on the Top500 supercomputer ranking:** China's Shenzhen-built system calculated 22% faster than the U.S.'s El Capitan at Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory.
 - **LineShine runs entirely on domestically developed CPUs and supporting hardware:** the machine uses homegrown processors, memory, networking, and cooling systems - no American chips - according to the Shenzhen center.
 - **China withdrew from Top500 rankings in 2023 amid suspected performance lead:** experts said they lacked data to confirm a Chinese machine had moved ahead until LineShine's April unveiling and participation.
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Nvidia's banned AI chips double in price on China's black market

- **Nvidia DGX B300 price doubled on China's black market:** The server now fetches over Rmb8mn (\$1.1mn), up from Rmb4mn six months ago, as US enforcement squeezes illicit supply routes, the FT reports.
 - **Supermicro co-founder charged with \$2.5bn Nvidia server smuggling:** The March indictment - the largest US AI chip export case on record - further disrupted black-market supply chains, chip traders told the FT.
 - **China GPU rental costs now match or exceed US rates:** An FT platform survey found parity or a premium for Blackwell systems, reversing a prior discount that reflected plentiful smuggled supply.
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How to power data centres

- **US and China hold 70% of global data centre energy consumption:** IEA data put total use at 415 TWh in 2024; McKinsey projects it reaching 1,400 TWh by 2030.
 - **China added 400GW of renewables in 2025 against the US's 53GW:** Its grid of nearly 4,000GW exceeds twice US installed capacity; a second Chinese small modular reactor entered testing in early 2026.
 - **China controls 90% of global lithium-iron-phosphate battery supply:** The US imports 80% of its power transformers, many from China, with Wood Mackenzie forecasting a 30% distribution transformer deficit in 2025.
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China's AI Boom Is Rewiring Its Power Grid

- **Four agencies issued joint AI-energy action plan in May 2026:** The NDRC-led plan sets a green energy guarantee for AI by 2027 and two-way AI-energy empowerment by 2030.
 - **China computing sector electricity rose to 196bn kWh in 2025:** Industry projections see 500-700bn kWh by 2030, potentially 5.3% of total national demand, per China Academy of ICT forecasts.
 - **AI load can swing 10,000 kW within milliseconds at gigawatt scale:** Grid planners class this as a security issue, citing a 2024 US storm that tripped 60 data centers.
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Beneath the Sea, China Tests the Future of AI Power

- **HiCloud's wind-powered underwater data center off Shanghai began commercial operations in February:** The 32-meter structure, cooled by seawater rather than freshwater, reports a power usage effectiveness rating of 1.15.
 - **HiCloud positioned the submerged data cabin alongside more than 50 offshore wind turbines:** The company describes the East China Sea installation as the world's first data center powered directly from offshore wind.
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This Megafactory Is a Test Case for the U.S.-China Tech Race

- **CATL commands 40% of global EV battery output:** The company's new battery delivers 250 miles of range on under 10 minutes of charging - about three times the speed of rival products.
 - **OECD puts Chinese industrial subsidies at 3-8x OECD peers:** A June 2026 study found Chinese firms received three to eight times more state support than OECD-country competitors over the past two decades.
 - **Beijing tightened outbound controls on battery manufacturing technology:** China added export restrictions on battery production processes and a stricter outbound investment review system, according to Rhodium Group analyst Reva Goujon.
-

China's CATL to offer battery swapping for Europe's electric trucks

- **CATL-Octopus Energy 50-50 JV targets European lorry battery-swap rollout:** The venture plans 30+ stations by 2035, potentially serving 300,000 electric trucks and generating over £30bn in private investment, with UK pilots beginning in 2027.
 - **CATL scales domestic swap network from 305 to 900 stations in 2026:** The company targets coverage of 80% of China's key logistics trunk roads by 2030 and expects half of China's vehicle market to run on electricity by 2028.
-

China's EV makers BYD, Xpeng move SUVs upmarket but risk glut

- **BYD and Xpeng push upmarket with Land Rover-style electric SUVs:** Chinese EV makers have unveiled at least 20 full-size electric SUVs in 2026, targeting higher-margin segments as domestic competition intensifies.
 - **Analysts warn rapid launches and discounting risk eroding returns:** Short product cycles and price cuts could undermine the margin gains the premium segment shift is designed to deliver, the article reports.
-

WSJ · 24 JUN 2026

InSilico Is on a Mission: Be No. 1 in China, Create 'God Drug' With AI

- **InSilico targets China's pharma market with "China for China" pivot:** CEO Zhavoronkov told WSJ that “if you use China as a platform, you’re going to gain two years of speed at the preclinical level” via AI-driven drug discovery.
 - **InSilico secured major deals with Eli Lilly and SK Biopharmaceuticals:** The agreements are valued at up to \$2.75 billion and \$2.5 billion respectively (Fortune/CNBC corroborate the headline figures).
-

NYT · 25 JUN 2026

'Too Good to Be True': A Chinese Study on Timing Cancer Therapy Is Retracted

- **Nature Medicine retracted a Chinese lung cancer immunotherapy timing study:** The journal cited mid-trial record alterations, Chinese-English protocol discrepancies, no patient dropouts/zero side-effect discontinuations in the first year, and “smooth PFS curves” as grounds.
 - **Retracted study claimed morning infusions nearly doubled patient survival:** Patients receiving pre-3 p.m. infusions reportedly lived 28 months versus 17 months for those infused later, the original February paper stated.
 - **China's biomedical research surge has drawn reliability scrutiny from U.S. officials:** The article reports China has rapidly become a drug development powerhouse, with critics questioning the consistency of its research standards.
-

SCMP · 26 JUN 2026

Is the U.S. banning drones from China until it can make better ones itself?

- **DJI drones remain operationally central to US public safety services:** Over 3,000 Americans, including emergency responders, filed comments with the FCC urging regulators not to restrict Chinese-made drone equipment.
 - **US regulatory pressure on DJI intensifies as geopolitical scrutiny of Chinese tech grows:** Washington’s tightening restrictions on Chinese technology have put DJI - which dominates the global commercial drone market - at the centre of a strategic policy debate.
-

GUARDIAN · 24 JUN 2026

The Guardian: What is China's SpaceSail, and could it rival Elon Musk's Starlink?

- **SpaceSail reaches 200 active satellites and begins maritime vessel tracking:** The state-backed SSST, funded with 6.7bn yuan from Chinese state institutions, targets 648 orbiting satellites and full commercial services by end 2026.
 - **SpaceSail targets markets where Starlink faces political friction:** The company is reportedly negotiating with 30 countries, securing commercial authorisation in Brazil after its Musk dispute and a Kazakhstan subsidiary after Starlink data talks failed.
-

Opinion: China's evolving political economy, as seen through gaokao scramble

- **China cancelled 12,000 university programmes between 2021 and 2025:** The education ministry removed humanities and management degrees while expanding enrolment quotas for **semiconductors and embodied intelligence**, the article reports.
- **Roughly one in three Chinese bachelor degrees are in engineering:** STEM accounts for ~26-28% of degrees in industrialised peers such as South Korea and Germany, the author notes – a wide engineering-share gap, though framed by the author as part of China's industrial-policy doubling-down rather than a "double".

3b. Geoeconomics – trade, finance & industrial policy

Chartbook 454: China shock 2.0 and mercantilist-on-mercantilist violence.

- **"China shock 2.0 is mercantilist-on-mercantilist violence" – focused on Germany and on cars:** Tooze frames 2.0 as fundamentally different from the early-2000s 1.0 (cost-of-production / low-wage shock that hit the US): 2.0 hits *Europe*, hits up-the-value-chain industrial sectors, and **60% of the €27 bn swing in Germany's China trade balance (2021→2025) is vehicles**. Germany itself runs a chronic trade surplus, and the EU's manufacturing trade surplus with the rest of the world is at new highs even as the China deficit widens – hence the "mercantilist-on-mercantilist" framing. The export surge is concentrated in green-energy goods (Europe's transition demand) and chemicals (Europe knocked back by gas prices).
 - **Tooze refuses the easy "subsidies + currency manipulation" story – then doubles down on it anyway:** CSIS estimates Chinese EV subsidies 2009–2023 at \$231 bn – comparable in scale to the EU Green Deal or Biden's IRA, with arguably superior industrial results. Meanwhile German Big-3 automakers paid out **€31 bn in dividends in 2023 alone** rather than reinvesting against the visible EV avalanche (Tordoir & Setser: "complacency"). But the yuan is pegged at an undervalued rate AND the *real* exchange rate is now depreciating – Western prices have risen since 2021, China hovers at the edge of deflation, so Chinese goods are structurally becoming more competitive over time, not less.
 - **Four macro options exhausted → "no macro solution on either side": sectoral defences + firm-level industrial bargains are what's left:** European internal devaluation is wrong-headed (EU runs an overall surplus; needs to raise demand, not lower it); yuan appreciation would deepen China's deflation; Chinese demand rebalancing is politically constrained (Pettis: Beijing has structural reasons to keep the current model – industrial development as an end + tens of millions of jobs). Tooze endorses the Setser/Tordoir prescription – sectoral trade defences + firm-level industrial bargains – with a hard demand on European industry: if EU protection is on the table, dividends should be capped and minimum reinvestment levels required. *"European industry needs saving from itself."*
-

China's premier says competitiveness not down to subsidies

- **Li Qiang rejected subsidy complaints at WEF Summer Davos:** China's premier attributed Chinese competitiveness to corporate R&D spending, not state support, saying "the Chinese government is not that wealthy".
 - **IMF estimates Chinese subsidies at 4% of GDP:** The fund called for them to be halved, citing international spillovers, as the US tariff war and EU trade measures over the same allegations escalate.
-

Chinese carmakers 'knocking at U.S. gate' from Mexico and Canada

- **Diverging Chinese-car policies risk derailing USMCA renewal ahead of a July 1 deadline:** Canada's vehicle manufacturers' association warned that courting Chinese automakers is "incompatible" with the country's trade relationship with the US.
 - **Canada cut Chinese EV tariffs from 100% to 6.1% for a capped 49,000-unit annual quota:** Imports could reach 70,000 annually within five years, while the industry minister met BYD, Chery, and Geely to discuss joint ventures.
 - **Chinese vehicles account for at least one in five new car sales in Mexico:** The true share is likely higher, as some brands including BYD do not report Mexican sales figures, the FT notes.
-

China's carmakers rush to Canada as a 'practice run' for U.S. sales

- **Chinese automakers entering Canada to rehearse eventual US sales:** BYD, Chery, Geely and Changan are pursuing Canadian dealerships despite a 49,000-vehicle import cap that limits near-term profits.
 - **Canada approved 49,000 Chinese EV imports annually at a 6.1% tariff:** Near-identical regulations and consumer tastes to the US make Canada a dealership and compliance testbed for the currently blocked American market.
-

China expo draws Nvidia, Apple, Micron as Beijing guards AI supply chain

- **US firms the largest foreign presence at Beijing supply chain expo:** Nvidia, Apple, and Micron were among American companies attending the China International Supply Chain Expo, which opened in Beijing on June 22, according to Nikkei.
 - **China expanded its export control list against US firms on the expo's opening day:** Beijing added more American companies to its export control and procurement ban lists on the same day the event began.
-

Chinese door-to-door logistics networks grow in U.S. to counter trade war

- **Chinese logistics firms build end-to-end US delivery networks:** Specialists help merchants cut costs and minimize tariff exposure, sidelining Western providers, according to industry experts cited by Nikkei.
 - **Temu goods reach US consumers via fully Chinese-run supply chains:** Products from Chinese bargain e-commerce platforms now travel from origin to American doorstep without entering Western-operated logistics networks.
-

Cross-border biotech deals grow more complex as U.S. targets China investment links

- **US scrutiny expected to slow but not reverse China-US biotech deal flow:** ING Research says investment controls may produce slightly fewer deals while Western pharma's broader trend of partnering with Chinese firms continues to expand.
 - **ING estimates China-West biotech out-licensing to reach \$240 billion in 2026:** The figure represents a near-doubling from \$136 billion in 2025, according to ING Research projections.
-

U.S. targets Cuba mining sector in move with implications for China-linked supply chains

- **US sanctions Cuba's state mining company and GAESA-linked entities:** Secretary Rubio announced measures against five entities and one individual, citing Washington's drive to build alternative supply chains for critical minerals and reduce reliance on geopolitical rivals.
 - **Cuba condemned sanctions days after announcing 176 economic reforms:** Havana unveiled the liberalisation package - covering private enterprise and investment - to revive an economy battered by prolonged blackouts and shortages of food, fuel and medicine.
-

Foreign Policy: China Flexes Its Rare-Earth Muscle – Again

- **Beijing banned rare-earth exports to MP Materials and USA Rare Earth:** China's Commerce Ministry prohibited dual-use exports to 10 U.S. firms it designates as military-linked, in direct response to Pentagon listings of Chinese companies.
 - **China controls roughly 90% of rare-earth refining and 95% of permanent magnet production:** Analysts cited by Foreign Policy describe the move as a "warning shot" rather than a materially disruptive measure, given that China was not actively supplying the two firms.
-

China Slaps Restrictions on Dozens of U.S. Companies

- **Beijing added rare earth producers to its military export controls:** China's Commerce Ministry barred Chinese exports with military applications to MP Materials, USA Rare Earth and 10 U.S. defense firms.
 - **Finance Ministry excluded 46 U.S. companies from Chinese government procurement:** Lockheed Martin, RTX and Boeing's defense division were named, with a carve-out protecting U.S.-invested enterprises operating inside China.
 - **Analysts described both measures as largely symbolic:** EIU economist Xu Tianchen cited U.S. firms' limited China presence and framed the moves as leverage-building for ongoing bilateral trade negotiations.
-

China Tightens Rare Earth Grip on U.S. Firms, Threatening Trade Clash

- **China bans MP Materials and USA Rare Earth from Chinese goods:** Beijing barred 10 US firms from buying dual-use goods, targeting the two DoD-backed companies leading efforts to rebuild domestic magnet manufacturing.
 - **Chinese heavy rare earth shipments to the US remain halted:** Customs data show no dysprosium exports to the US since April 2025 and no terbium since last October, the article reports.
 - **China preparing tighter global rare earth export restrictions for November:** Beijing plans stricter worldwide controls, compounding 14 months of restrictions that have disrupted car, military, and robotics supply chains outside China.
-

A \$30 Billion Cancer Breakthrough Is Under Threat From Global Conflicts

- **The supply chain runs through Russia and China – two of Europe's most-frayed relationships:** The active isotope, lutetium-177, is produced by neutron-bombarding enriched **ytterbium-176** in nuclear reactors. Until recently “almost all of the ytterbium-176 came from Russia.” China then added ytterbium to its rare-earth export-control list in **October 2024** (implementation suspended through November 2026) – and export-licence applications require companies to submit potentially proprietary information.
 - **Reactor capacity + a 6.6-day half-life amplify the geopolitical risk:** Aging European research reactors are prone to outages (a Dutch reactor went offline in 2024, cancelling thousands of patient appointments); lutetium-177's 6.6-day half-life means no inventory buffer is possible, and Middle East-conflict air-route disruptions have already hit logistics. China has separately designated radiopharmaceuticals a national priority research area and Novartis plans a Chinese manufacturing site – Beijing's own bid to capture the supply chain Europe still depends on.
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Foreign Policy: China's De-Dollarization Drive Has Hit a Wall

- **PBoC unveiled a new yuan internationalisation blueprint on 17 June:** The governor announced offshore trading pilots and fresh central bank swap lines ahead of the September BRICS summit in New Delhi.
 - **Yuan use remains under 5% of global trade:** Capital controls and thin clearing networks confine renminbi settlement almost entirely to deals involving Chinese counterparts, with global take-up marginal.
 - **Dollar stablecoins reach \$317 billion as the e-CNY stalls:** The digital yuan processes \$6 billion daily against \$150 billion for Alipay and WeChat Pay combined, the article reports.
-

Opinion: Why sinodollars outweigh the petroyuan

- **Yuan oil settlement rising but no petroyuan pool forming:** Oil exporters spend yuan on imports rather than hold it, preventing the offshore accumulation that made petrodollars powerful, the article argues.
 - **China's trade surpluses generate "sinodollars" that dwarf petroyuan:** East Asian manufacturer surpluses recycled at over \$1tn a year far exceed any plausible petroyuan volume, the author argues.
-

China Is Luring the World to the Yuan – and Hobbling Western Sanctions

- **Iran earned up to \$43 billion in oil revenues in 2024 despite U.S. sanctions:** The U.S. Treasury reports most sales were settled in yuan through China's financial system, beyond Washington's monitoring reach.
 - **China's CIPS network averaged \$115 billion in daily transactions in early 2026, up from \$100 billion in 2025:** The Atlantic Council attributes the increase to greater use following the outbreak of the U.S.-Iran conflict.
 - **China's mBridge platform recorded its first government-to-government payment in November 2025:** The U.A.E. Vice President initiated the transfer to Beijing; digital yuan now constitutes 95% of the platform's cross-border payments, according to the Atlantic Council.
-

Rest of World: China and the West are taking opposite paths on EV battery recycling

- **China's April 2026 rules mandate immediate metal recovery from spent EV batteries:** New regulations dropped reuse as a policy goal, requiring direct shredding for lithium, nickel, and cobalt, according to a government statement.
 - **China holds over 85% of global EV battery recycling capacity:** Officials cited over 90% import dependence for cobalt and nickel as the strategic rationale for the mandate, according to state broadcaster CCTV.
 - **The U.S. has no national EV battery recycling plan as its demand share shrinks:** Its share of global battery demand is projected to fall from around 10% to under 5% by 2030, per the Global EV Outlook.
-

China lines up second LNG terminal for sanctioned Russian cargoes

- **PipeChina's Longkou terminal lined up for sanctioned Arctic LNG 2:** China is readying a second Shandong import terminal - due before October - expanding its role as the project's only buyer, sources told Reuters.
 - **Beihai has taken 41 Arctic LNG 2 cargoes - 2.6 million tons - since August 2025:** Novatek cut cargo prices 30-40% to retain China as the project's sole offtaker, which imported 7.57 million tons of Russian LNG last year in total.
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Chinese appliance brands gain ground in Southeast Asia

- **Chinese appliances gain SE Asia market share via TVs and air conditioners:** Share has risen over five years, with younger buyers attracted by price, innovative design, and 24/7 service support, according to Nikkei.
 - **Chinese brands differentiate on service and design, not only cost:** Manufacturers are competing through around-the-clock customer support and product innovation to challenge Japanese and South Korean rivals across the region.
-

China Reopens a Business Channel to Japan While Political Ties Remain Frozen

- **Beijing quietly resumed a high-level business dialogue with Japan:** First such formal economic channel since the **2025-2026 China-Japan diplomatic crisis** that began in autumn 2025; political track (defence, security) remains frozen.
- **Pragmatic decoupling:** The piece argues Beijing is separating commercial engagement from strategic confrontation – a pattern with parallels for EU-China policy discussions.

4. Foreign policy and 'Global China'

How China's Navy Is Tightening the Noose on Taiwan

- **China's naval encirclement of Taiwan has grown from one warship to five-or-six since 2020:** Beijing escalated from a single vessel to three warships in 2020, a fourth on the east in 2022, a fifth in 2024, and a sixth more recently – today five or six PLA vessels are present on all four sides of the island almost continuously, per security officials cited by WSJ.
 - **Rotating deployments give Chinese crews operational experience and intelligence:** Ships take two-week turns, with varied crews observing Taiwan's defensive responses – including during repeated "joint combat readiness patrols" that push inside the 24-nautical-mile contiguous zone, according to security officials.
 - **Taiwan's navy strained by PLA combat-readiness patrols:** Taiwan recorded 40 such PLA joint combat-readiness patrols in 2024 and 15 so far in 2025; shadow responses now often run up to 48 hours, straining its far smaller fleet, Taiwanese officials said.
-

U.S. says China trying to discourage states, businesses from engaging with Taiwan

- **Washington warned states and firms of Chinese pressure over Taiwan:** Joint letters from State, Agriculture, and Commerce say Chinese embassies contact US officials and firms to discourage Taiwan engagement.
 - **Letters accuse Beijing's missions of misrepresenting US Taiwan policy:** China's embassies falsely claim Washington has accepted Beijing's specific position on Taiwan sovereignty, the letters allege.
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Raymond Greene interview: 'Maintaining the status quo is the basis for cross-strait dialogue' (谷立言專訪：維持現狀 是兩岸對話的基礎 / Gu Lìyán zhuānfā ng: Wéichí xiànzhuàng shì liǎng'àn duìhuà de jīchū)

- **AIT director cites 70% status quo support as cross-strait dialogue basis:** Raymond Greene said any future governing party is very likely to maintain this consensus, given its strong and sustained public backing.
 - **Greene called for cross-strait engagement without Beijing's preconditions:** He said unconditional interaction is the best way to avoid misjudgment and find a peaceful resolution to differences.
 - **US used KMT chairperson's visit to stress Taiwan defense investment:** Greene said Washington conveyed that building defense capabilities is a prerequisite for maintaining peace in the Taiwan Strait.
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'Salami-slicing': China's latest moves show how it's increasing control in the Pacific

- **China expanded Coast Guard / Maritime Safety Administration presence inside the First Island Chain:** Vessels operating east of Taiwan and around Scarborough Shoal mark a steady push outside the Nine-Dash Line baseline, per CNN.
 - **Classic salami-slicing in the SCS and Taiwan flank:** Beijing's incremental presence at Scarborough Shoal and east of Taiwan is each too small to trigger pushback but cumulatively shifts the operating envelope along the first island chain.
-

China's pressure revives ancient Japanese sense of crisis

- **Xi and Takaichi both playing to domestic audiences:** The article reports that both leaders' posturing is costing their nations the diplomatic go-betweens historically needed to heal bilateral rifts.
 - **Author draws parallel to 663 AD Battle of Baekgang:** The article argues Chinese pressure is reviving Japan's ancient sense of existential crisis, pushing bilateral ties toward an abyss.
-

Chinese translation of Tokyo war trial records fill 'critical gap': state media

- **China released first complete Chinese-language Tokyo Trial court records:** The 40-volume translation, produced by hundreds of scholars over a decade, covers nearly 50,000 pages of transcripts, testimony, and judgment documents, Xinhua reported.
 - **Chinese officials linked the release to countering Japan's "neo-militarism":** Foreign ministry spokeswoman Mao Ning explicitly framed the publication as a tool against what Beijing characterises as Japan's ongoing military build-up.
-

China Sharpens Tools for Hitting Back at Foreign Sanctions

- **China's legislature reviewed a bill empowering state prosecutors:** The draft would allow civil suits against foreign organizations or individuals deemed to have damaged China's national or public interests.
 - **AmCham China said its members will monitor implementation closely:** The chamber - representing over 800 mainly U.S. companies - cited transparency and due process as conditions for maintaining investment confidence.
-

China says it has a right to target people overseas with new ethnic unity law

- **New ethnic-unity law (effective July 1) asserts extraterritorial reach:** A clause explicitly states the law applies to acts committed abroad that "undermine ethnic unity" – Beijing's most explicit codification yet of transnational repression authority.
 - **Western governments warn of expanded transnational repression:** Activists, Tibetans, Uyghurs and Hong Kongers abroad seen as primary targets; the law dovetails with the parallel "Patriotic Education" and counter-espionage frameworks.
-

'China Opportunity 2.0': Li Qiang pitches revised narrative at 'Summer Davos'

- **Li Qiang reframes "China Shock 2.0" as "China Opportunity 2.0" at Summer Davos:** Speaking at the World Economic Forum's Annual Meeting of the New Champions in Dalian, the Premier argued China's export competitiveness stems from industrial effort, not state subsidies.
 - **Li cited Huawei's 1 trillion yuan decade-long R&D spend to rebut subsidy claims:** He also flagged rising AI risks - including "technological runaway" - as requiring closer international cooperation.
-

China plans postwar aid for Iran, with eye on energy supply

- **Beijing prepares post-war reconstruction aid for Iran:** China is developing economic and diplomatic support for Tehran following a US-Iran peace deal, aiming to secure Iranian oil imports, Nikkei reports.
- **China to tread carefully with US and Gulf states:** Beijing is crafting aid plans designed to avoid antagonising Washington and Gulf partners while supporting Iran's reconstruction, according to Nikkei.

5. Strategic implications and responses

FOREIGN AFFAIRS · 23 JUN 2026

The Mirage of China's Military Edge

- **Classified DOD war games consistently show China unable to seize Taiwan:** Pentagon simulations with classified data from both sides found the PLA consistently thwarted in its invasion objective, the author reports.
 - **US hypersonic missiles and allied buildups are widening deterrence advantages:** American systems in the Pacific can strike China's coastal invasion infrastructure; Japan and the Philippines have separately strengthened their own defenses in response to Chinese aggression.
 - **China's limited military options would not compel Taiwanese capitulation:** Strikes, blockades, and island seizures would harden resistance, invite sanctions, and leave Beijing facing escalation or retreat, the author argues.
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FOREIGN AFFAIRS · 24 JUN 2026

Foreign Affairs: China Could Win Taiwan Without Fighting

- **Trump paused Taiwan's \$14 billion arms package post-summit:** He said he and Xi discussed arms sales "in great detail," breaking with the US practice of not consulting Beijing on Taiwan.
 - **China launched coast guard operations near Taiwan after the summit:** Beijing interfered with commercial shipping off the east coast and entered prohibited waters near a South China Sea island Taiwan controls.
 - **Taiwanese trust in US credibility fell to 34% by 2026:** The figure had already declined more than ten points over five years before Trump's post-summit statements, according to the article.
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REUTERS · 24 JUN 2026

Taiwan says warning time for any China attack is shortening

- **Taiwan's five-day drills test immediate peacetime-to-wartime response:** Defence Minister Wellington Koo said exercises are now based on a scenario in which China suddenly converts its regular military activities into an actual attack.
 - **China's newest carrier transited the Taiwan Strait as drills began:** Beijing's Taiwan Affairs Office condemned the exercises as "malicious intent" and reiterated that China will not renounce the use of force against Taiwan.
 - **Taiwan targets 5% of GDP for defence spending before 2030:** President Lai's modernisation push received U.S. backing from diplomat Raymond Greene, who said Washington aims to maintain the first island chain status quo and prevent a forcible takeover.
-

Taiwan Drill Simulates Maritime 'Quarantine' by Chinese Forces

- **Taiwan ran tabletop exercises simulating a Chinese maritime quarantine:** The drill modelled China requiring vessels to register through its customs system and detaining ships under law enforcement cover, officials said.
 - **Eleven ministries participated, including Defence, Foreign Affairs, and the Ocean Affairs Council:** The quarantine drill ran alongside a separate nationwide combat readiness exercise, reflecting Taiwan's preparation for multiple conflict scenarios.
 - **Supply disruption protocols were rehearsed under the quarantine scenario:** Taiwan's transport authority would alert commercial vessels to avoid certain waters, while the government monitored energy stocks and conducted emergency procurement of essential goods.
-

The next phase in the U.S.-China economic war is here

- **Pentagon's 1260H list reached a record 188 Chinese designations:** The June 8 update added 65 firms - including BYD, Alibaba, Baidu and TP-Link - expanding into consumer EVs, biotech and solar sectors.
 - **China counter-listed MP Materials and USA Rare Earth:** Beijing's Commerce Ministry barred Chinese firms from supplying the two companies central to Washington's domestic rare earth supply chain independence push.
 - **Commerce Dept entity blacklist has not been updated since October:** Reuters reported that over 100 approved Chinese designations - including DeepSeek and CXMT - remain unpublished, attributed to efforts to avoid bilateral escalation.
-

'China Initiative 2.0': U.S. crackdown on Chinese scholars intensifies

- **US lawyers report a surge in investigations targeting China-linked researchers:** Speaking at an Asian-American Scholar Forum panel, attorneys described a "large uptick" in federal and state probes, though most have not yet led to indictments.
 - **Crackdown compared to the original "China Initiative" - which was scrapped in 2022:** The Trump-era programme was discontinued after criticism of racial profiling; activists argue the current targeting of Chinese scientists is more aggressive than its predecessor.
-

Alibaba sues Pentagon over inclusion on Chinese military blacklist

- **Alibaba filed suit against the Pentagon over its 1260H military-company listing:** A California district court filing argues the designation was "arbitrary and capricious" and unsupported by substantial evidence of PLA ties.
 - **Listing exposes the company to state divestment mandates and potential NYSE delisting:** Alibaba warned in its filing that the federal designation materially increases the likelihood its securities face state-level divestiture orders.
 - **China restricted US companies - including rare earths firms - in retaliation for the blacklist additions:** The measure followed the Pentagon's designation of Alibaba, BYD, and other major Chinese companies, according to the FT.
-

Canada calls for 'discipline' with China as it beefs up Japan defense ties

- **Canada's defense minister called for "disciplined" China engagement during Tokyo visit:** Ottawa is simultaneously pursuing improved relations with Beijing while deepening military cooperation with Japan, the minister said.
 - **Minister cited the "two Michaels" precedent on a detained Japanese national:** The case requires "patience," Canada's defense minister said, recalling Canadians previously held by China in a diplomatic standoff.
-

Japan's defence outreach to counter China's military rise hits hidden roadblocks

- **Japan rebutted Beijing's "new militarism" charge at Shangri-La Dialogue:** Defence Minister Koizumi argued Tokyo's military buildup responds to China's growing capabilities and lack of transparency, not aggression.
 - **Japan lifted its lethal weapons export ban in April:** The policy change allows Tokyo to sell defence equipment to 17 countries, including six ASEAN nations, according to SCMP.
 - **Tokyo deepened bilateral defence ties with Manila and Wellington:** Japan and the Philippines advanced a classified military information agreement, while a Japanese frigate was shortlisted to replace New Zealand's Anzac-class fleet.
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Japan defense forces used USB drives with China-linked virus

- **Japan's Self-Defense Forces used China-linked infected USB drives on classified computers:** The contaminated drives were operated on systems with access to classified information for nearly a year, a Nikkei investigation found.
 - **SDF chose not to disclose the incident despite similar infected drives available online:** Similar China-linked virus-infected memory sticks were widely obtainable from online retailers at the time, Nikkei reports.
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The Middle Power Delusion

- **Beckley argues the middle-power moment was historically anomalous:** Increased visibility reflects great-power predation and erosion of the US-led order, the article contends, not genuine multipolarity.
 - **Niche leverage differs fundamentally from structural power, the author argues:** Middle powers controlling key nodes - TSMC chips, Chilean lithium, Turkish straits - still depend on US dollars, markets, and security.
 - **Explicit alignment beats hedging, Beckley concludes:** Japan, Finland, Sweden, and Australia are cited as models gaining strategic room by making themselves indispensable inside the US system.
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What the West Can Learn From China – Without Becoming It

- **New book argues the West must borrow China's economic tools:** “How to Win a Trade War” contends democracies need industrial policy, stockpiling, and export controls to counter China’s state-directed dominance.
 - **Authors prescribe narrow subsidies and allied lockstep on export controls:** Broad subsidies risk allied friction and domestic waste, while export controls require partner coordination to block adversary workarounds, the authors argue.
 - **China's rare-earth leverage secured U.S. concessions in the trade truce:** Bown says the outcome shows economic weapons can alter adversary behavior short-term, though durability remains unproven.
-

U.S. Supreme Court limits scope of foreign human rights claims

- **Supreme Court backs Cisco against Falun Gong surveillance claims:** Justices declined to consider allegations that Cisco aided Beijing’s “Golden Shield” system used to target Falun Gong members.
- **Decision extends two decades of ATS restrictions by US courts:** The ruling may shield corporations from legal scrutiny over dealings with governments accused of human rights abuses, the FT reports.

IV. Chinese Sources

Authoritative texts

PREMIER LI QIANG (STATE COUNCIL) · 24 JUN 2026

Full text of Li Qiang's address at the opening plenary of the 17th Annual Meeting of the New Champions (Summer Davos, Dalian)

- **Li explicitly counter-frames "China Shock 2.0" as "China Opportunity 2.0"**: The Premier rejects the Western narrative that China's industrial breakthroughs threaten others, arguing Chinese competitiveness stems from corporate R&D, manufacturing scale and a vast domestic application market – not from “outsized” subsidies. This is the highest-level Chinese rebuttal yet of the Setser/Tordoir framing that drove the EU Council week.
- **Sets the line for the 15th Five-Year Plan period (2026-2030) – innovation cooperation as the diplomatic ask**: Li uses the address to position China as a global growth anchor entering the FYP transition, urging “global leaders to advance global innovation cooperation, build bridges and generate fresh ideas through exchange and mutual learning” – Beijing's diplomatic framing as Šefčovič-Wang talks open in Brussels.

Regulatory & policy primary sources

MOFCOM + NDRC + MOF · 16 JUN 2026

Action Plan for Stabilizing and Optimizing Foreign Investment Utilization (利用外资固稳促优行动方案, 商资发〔2026〕97号)

- **Joint three-ministry plan opens five fronts to re-court FDI**: Market access expansion, deepened services opening, foreign-investment participation in priority industries, business-environment optimisation and approval simplification — explicit response to the FDI slump.

MOFCOM · 24 JUN 2026

Measures for Industrial and Supply Chain Security Investigations (产业链供应链安全调查办法, MOFCOM Announcement No. 24 of 2026)

- **Operationalises the State Council's April 2026 supply-chain security framework**: 22-article rules name MOFCOM as the lead investigative agency; Article 4 lists four harm categories (critical materials/tech/data; logistics-trade-people-capital-data flows; international competitiveness; “other”).
 - **Article 8 expands investigative powers including cross-border on-site**: Interviews, document inspection/copying, public solicitation, questionnaires, sampling, technical assessments, hearings, and — notably — on-site investigations in foreign jurisdictions where they “do not object” — substantial extraterritorial reach.
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New restrictions on US defence, tech and rare-earth firms

- **10 US defence firms added to MOFCOM's export-control list including MP Materials and USA Rare Earth:** Bars exports of any Chinese-made products with potential military application — Beijing's most pointed rare-earth-side retaliation to date.
-

15th Five-Year Plan for New Energy System Construction (新型能源体系建设十五五规划, 发改能源〔2026〕884号)

- **First joint NDRC-NEA five-year energy plan to follow approval by State Council:** Sets the strategic frame for 2026-2030 build-out of “new energy system” — renewable scale-up, grid integration of variable power, energy storage, and the computing-power-synergy agenda flagged in Caixin's “AI Boom Rewiring Power Grid” piece.
 - **Plan formalises shift from coal-anchored to renewable-anchored backbone:** Sets binding targets for non-fossil installed capacity, transmission infrastructure, and integrated storage; provides regulatory cover for the Ulanqab / Zhongwei / “Eastern Data Western Computing” computing-hub model.
-

Draft amendment on civil public-interest litigation incl. cross-border prosecution authority

- **NPC SC reviewed a draft empowering procurators to bring civil suits against foreign actors for harming national/public interests:** Per Trivium pointer (W26); reads alongside the just-passed Ethnic Unity Law (effective July 1) — explicit codification of Beijing's extraterritorial legal reach.
 - **Session also took up trademark law revisions, financial stability law and public procurement law amendments:** Broader package signals legislative emphasis on economic-security and statecraft infrastructure rather than market liberalisation.
-

Annual Audit Report on 2024 Central Budget Execution (关于2024年度中央预算执行和其他财政收支的审计工作报告)

- **Hidden local-government debt deception flagged in the audit:** Several provinces artificially reduced reported hidden-debt balances — in some cases by deleting records from the debt-management system; some LGFVs falsely claimed resolved debts (see Caixin slot-3 write-up).
 - **17 counties inflated SPB project returns to secure 12.2bn yuan in special-purpose bond proceeds:** Some regions also misused SPB funds for unauthorised expenses including government buildings and corporate loan repayments — quantifying enforcement failure in the deleverage mandate.
-

May 2026 monthly nationwide statistics: 24,513 cases of 八项规定 violations (2026年5月全国查处违反中央八项规定精神问题24513起)

- **Sustained anti-graft enforcement at high tempo: 24,513 violations punished in May alone:** The release maintains visibility of the campaign that has also taken down Bian Zhigang (SASTIND/CNSA), the 6 PLA generals removed from NPC, and other senior figures.
- **Eight-Point monthly cadence signals institutionalisation, not winding-down:** Continued discipline-side pressure on cadres parallels the broader political-loyalty drive Xi has reinforced ahead of the 21st Party Congress preparations.

Government positions & readouts

MFA SPOKESPERSON GUO JIAKUN · 25 JUN 2026

Press conference – Taiwan EEZ / east-of-Taiwan Coast Guard patrols

- **Beijing's most explicit official codification yet of jurisdiction in the waters east of Taiwan:** Asked by Reuters about Chinese Coast Guard patrols east of Taiwan, Guo asserts that “according to China’s domestic law and international law including UNCLOS, China has exclusive economic zone and continental shelf in waters east of China’s Taiwan island” – framing the patrols as legitimate exercise of Chinese jurisdiction. Pairs directly with the CNN “salami-slicing” piece (Part III §4): the operational creep at Scarborough Shoal and east of Taiwan is now backed by an explicit MFA legal claim.

MFA SPOKESPERSON GUO JIAKUN · 24 JUN 2026

Press conference - Xi-Pyongyang visit framing

Quality CN journalism

CAIXIN · 22 JUN 2026

In AI Pitch, Alibaba Chairman Urges Europe to Look Beyond U.S. Tech

- **Joe Tsai pitched Alibaba Cloud and Qwen models as European AI alternatives:** At a Brussels-focused event he positioned Chinese AI as a hedge against US export controls and the Anthropic/OpenAI restrictions that briefly cut Europe off.
 - **Deliberate gambit to fracture the Pax Silica alignment:** Tsai’s outreach lands days before the EU signs the US-led “Pax Silica” declaration singling out China on AI chips — a direct attempt to give European firms a counter-narrative.
-

China Advances Central Bank Law Revision to Counter Foreign Sanctions

- **PBoC law revision adds an explicit anti-sanctions toolkit:** The amendment would codify the central bank's authority to take retaliatory financial measures against foreign sanctions, formalising powers it has so far exercised ad hoc.
 - **Part of the broader "law as a tool" agenda:** Reads alongside the 2023 Counter-Espionage Law expansion and the 2024 anti-sanctions framework — signalling Beijing is consolidating a permanent legal infrastructure for economic statecraft.
-

China Rolls Out 15-Point Plan to Woo Foreign Capital

- **State Council unveiled a 15-point package to court foreign investors:** Measures span market access expansion, simpler approval processes, and protections against discriminatory enforcement — a recognition that FDI inflows have slumped.
- **Timed to counter the China-shock 2.0 narrative:** Release coincides with EU Council preparing tariffs on Chinese plug-in hybrids and Brussels' diversification push, signalling Beijing's parallel attempt to keep European capital onside.

Chinese thinking

Wang Huiyao: Europe was happy with the trade rules — until China's industrial rise

- **CCG president frames Western anxieties as revisionist:** Wang argues the West embraced WTO rules when they served Atlantic incumbents, and now seeks to rewrite them as Chinese industrial capacity reshapes the bargain.
 - **Explicitly contests the "non-market practices" framing:** Wang reframes EU/US complaints about subsidies and overcapacity as protectionism dressed up as fairness — a key elite-CN narrative ahead of the EU's anti-coercion deployment.
-

Nie Huihua on the non-Westernness of Chinese government and the challenge to innovation

- **Renmin University economist defends a "non-Western" governance model:** Nie argues China's state-led developmental approach is structurally distinct from Western liberal-democratic capitalism and should not be assessed on Western metrics.
 - **Acknowledges innovation system frictions:** Concedes that the same top-down model that drove industrial scale-up now bottlenecks frontier innovation — a notable internal admission as Beijing pushes the "new productive forces" line.
-

Modernization of the Global South: Key Issues and Lessons from China (5,211 views)

- **Three structural dilemmas of Global South modernization, framed as failures of Western prescription:** Tian diagnoses the “infant industry protection paradox” of import-substitution and the “deindustrialization / dependent development / dollar-cycle” trap of export-orientation — arguing both Western-derived strategies leave developing economies stuck on the periphery.
 - **China's path positioned as a "developmental state" template for the Global South:** Tian distills five lessons — alignment with national conditions, building a “developmental state” with “development-first” governance, technological “overtaking on the curve,” social transformation for “modernization for the majority,” and South-South solidarity inside a “new globalization.”
 - **Treats the post-1945 "liberal international order" explicitly as a neocolonial system:** The article reframes the Bretton Woods architecture as substituting capital expansion and unequal exchange for direct colonial rule — providing the intellectual backing for the Global Governance Initiative's restructuring agenda.
-

The Civilizational Value and Practical Effectiveness of the Global Governance Initiative — A Historical Materialism Analysis (3,502 views)

- **Doctrinal grounding of the GGI in historical materialism:** Zheng argues the new initiative responds to a structural mismatch between globalized productive forces (digital economy, AI, Global South rise) and the “Western-dominated” relations of production embedded in post-WWII institutions — establishing reform as a Marxist “historical necessity.”
 - **Five-pillar GGI doctrine codified:** Sovereign equality · international rule of law · multilateralism · people-centeredness · action-orientation — explicitly positioned as China's fourth global “public good” after the GDI, GSI and GCI.
 - **Frames "Western-centrism" as the ideological superstructure of capital expansion:** Zheng explicitly attacks “universal values” and the “end of history” narrative as a “universalisation of the particular” — and argues the GGI provides intellectual cover for civilizational diversity and “pluralistic modernization paths,” directly contesting Western normative authority.
-

Clarifying the Three Logical Boundaries of Nuclear Strategic Stability in the Intelligent Age (2,199 views)

- **Reframes the AI/nuclear debate from "human-in-the-loop" to "consequences-in-the-loop":** Liu argues AI's most consequential effect is not replacing decision-makers but vastly expanding their menu of feasible options — citing the Maduro seizure, the Khamenei decapitation strike, and AI-enabled Gaza operations as examples where AI lowered the threshold for catastrophic actions.
 - **Calls for mandatory time-buffers in nuclear-crisis decision-making:** Drawing on the Cuban Missile Crisis precedent, Liu warns AI may compress decision-making timelines from hours to seconds — proposes a principle that "AI should not become a tool for compressing nuclear-crisis decision-making time," requiring coordination among the major powers.
 - **Warns of "nuclear scope creep" as cyber/critical-infrastructure threats migrate into the nuclear-deterrence frame:** Liu argues AI's enhancement of target identification and cyber capabilities risks pulling conventional contingencies under a nuclear lens — implicitly criticising US doctrinal trends and pushing back on expansive nuclear-deterrence postures.
-

The Ukraine Issue Returns to the International Spotlight — G7 vs Russia (1,330 views)

- **Chinese read of the June 16-17 G7 Évian summit as a Western consolidation of long-term Ukraine commitment:** Zhou parses the G7 statement's four pillars — additional air defence + long-range capabilities, licensing Ukraine to produce weapons domestically (incl. Western defence factories on Ukrainian soil), energy/financial resilience aid for the winter, and stepped-up oil-and-gas sanctions on Russia — concluding Trump's "promotion of peace through talks" has been reversed by the European-led coalition.
- **Identifies a Trump-flattery pattern in the G7 statement:** Zhou notes the G7 statement mentions Trump three times and ties Russia sanctions reinstatement to the Strait-of-Hormuz reopening — reading this as European leaders "classically flattering" Trump to secure US cooperation on Ukraine despite his earlier ambivalence.
- **Quotes vdL: "The wind is turning in Ukraine's favor" — Zhou reads this as European propaganda against Russian-side battlefield realities:** The Chinese framing dismisses Western "exhaustion" claims and casts the new aid architecture as proof Europe is now the core external force prolonging the war, with Russia (via Lavrov's June 19 article) hardening its bottom line.

CN coverage of EU/GER

Wang Yi highlights Austria's role in China-Europe links

- **Wang Yi singles out Austria as a "bridge" between China and Europe:** During his meeting with Austrian FM Beate Meinl-Reisinger — Beijing publicly rewarding member states that resist the bloc-level hardening on China and positioning Austria as a model of "pragmatic" EU-China engagement.
-

China Chamber of Commerce to EU warns of additional uncertainty from EU's plan to develop the Industrial Accelerator Act

- **CCCEU frames EU Industrial Accelerator Act + "Buy European" as protectionism, not response to overcapacity:** Beijing's most active industry voice in Brussels previews the narrative Beijing will deploy if the EU operationalises the diversification instrument and IPI extensions – framing the measures as costs to European consumers rather than legitimate trade defence.
-

EU joining Pax Silica comes at cost of AI independence: expert

- **Pax Silica signature framed as US-vassalage:** Chinese state-media analysts argue Europe traded “AI independence” for transatlantic AI security – the commentary lines up with Joe Tsai's parallel pitch to European firms to look beyond US tech (see Caixin Alibaba entry in slot 3 above).
-

Brussels' protectionist moves risk being costly backfiring gamble to EU

- **Party-line editorial frames EU trade-defence moves as economic self-harm:** Signals any EU activation of new instruments (anti-coercion, diversification, sectoral quotas) will draw not just retaliation but a co-ordinated narrative campaign aimed at European publics and capitals.
-

Trade deficits alone cannot define China-EU economic ties

- **Xinhua pre-empts the €360 bn deficit headline:** The commentary argues the deficit number obscures Chinese investment, climate cooperation and intermediate-goods value-chains – effectively Beijing's “don't reduce us to a number” message to EU leaders ahead of the Šefčovič-Wang Brussels meeting.
-

Chinese investment in Europe offers an opportunity, not a risk

- **Chinese FDI framed as opportunity, not security risk:** Beijing leans hard on the EU-investment narrative – a direct counter to the new EU FDI-Screening Regulation 2026/1386 and the security-driven anti-subsidy / IPI tooling.

Caveat: nur stichprobenartig auf Qualität / Richtigkeit überprüft — Coverage nur bis 28. Juni 2026.

1. Prominente Zitate und Positionen zu China-bezogenen Angelegenheiten

HANDELSBLATT · 25 JUN 2026

Li Qiang (Ministerpräsident, VR China) wies am 24. Juni beim Sommer-Weltwirtschaftsforum (Sommer-Davos) in Dalian die These eines China-Schocks zurück und forderte stattdessen, von China-Chance 2.0 zu sprechen: „Es sollte nicht China -Schock 2.0 sein, sondern China -Chance 2.0“; Chinas Wettbewerbsfähigkeit beruhe auf harter Arbeit und starken Lieferketten, nicht auf übermäßigen Subventionen: „So reich ist die chinesische Regierung nicht – solche Subventionen könnten wir gar nicht in diesem Umfang leisten“

“LI QIANG; Chinas Premier weist Vorwürfe zurück”

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 24 JUN 2026

Ding Xuexiang (Vize-Premierminister, VR China) warnte am 23. Juni, zur Eröffnung der Lieferkettenmesse in Peking, einige Akteure würden „das Konzept der Sicherheit überstrapazieren und Exportkontrollen missbrauchen“; China verstehe sich als Verteidiger und Mitgestalter stabiler globaler Lieferketten

“Sommer-Davos; Chinas Premier Li Qiang weist Subventionsvorwürfe zurück”

ZEIT.DE · 20 JUN 2026

Ursula von der Leyen (Präsidentin, EU-Kommission) kündigte am 20. Juni, in Brüssel nach dem EU-Gipfel an, Unternehmen per Gesetz zur breiteren Streuung ihrer Lieferanten zu verpflichten, um die Abhängigkeit von China zu verringern; Unternehmen bauten ihre Risiken bislang zu langsam ab; die Dringlichkeit habe sich 2025 gezeigt, als China seine Vormachtstellung bei Seltenen Erden für Exportbeschränkungen genutzt habe

“China und die EU; EU plant Vorgaben für geringere wirtschaftliche Abhängigkeit von China”

ZEIT.DE · 20 JUN 2026

António Costa (Präsident, Europäischer Rat) erklärte am 20. Juni, in Brüssel, das EU-China-Handelsdefizit von rund einer Milliarde Euro pro Tag sei „schlicht nicht tragbar“ und China habe „leider nicht geliefert“: Wir können dieses Thema nicht weiter ansprechen, ohne konkrete Ergebnisse zu erzielen. Und bis jetzt hat China leider nicht geliefert.

“China und die EU; EU plant Vorgaben für geringere wirtschaftliche Abhängigkeit von China”

HANDELSBLATT · 22 JUN 2026

Friedrich Merz (Bundeskanzler, CDU) erklärte am 20. Juni, nach dem EU-Gipfel in Brüssel: „Wir waren uns einig, dass wir uns als größter Binnenmarkt der Welt vor marktverzerrenden Praktiken und Ungleichgewichten besser schützen müssen“; forderte zudem eine Neuauflage des Plaza-Abkommens zur Aufwertung des chinesischen Yuan, den er als um 20 bis 30 Prozent unterbewertet bezeichnete

“IMPORTFLUT; Deutschlands China -Schock ist ,größtenteils hausgemacht“

ZEIT.DE · 20 JUN 2026

Manfred Weber (CSU-Vizechef, Vorsitzender der EVP-Fraktion, EU-Parlament) warnte am 20. Juni anlässlich des EU-Gipfels: „Entweder wir wehren uns oder China macht Teile unserer Industrie platt“

“EU-Gipfel in Brüssel; Sorry, das reicht wirklich noch nicht!“

ZEIT.DE · 20 JUN 2026

Bart De Wever (Premierminister, Belgien) erklärte am 20. Juni, in Brüssel, Vergeltungsmaßnahmen Chinas würden EU-Mitglieder unterschiedlich treffen: „Nicht jeder ist gleichermaßen verwundbar“ – die Einigkeit der EU-Mitglieder sei daher „entscheidend“

„China und die EU; EU plant Vorgaben für geringere wirtschaftliche Abhängigkeit von China“

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 20 JUN 2026

Christian Stocker (Bundeskanzler, Österreich, ÖVP) erklärte am 20. Juni, in Brüssel: „Wir gehen mit vielen Partnern sehr vorsichtig um, inklusive China“ und forderte eine Neuausrichtung des EU-China-Verhältnisses; China sei derzeit eher ein systemischer Rivale als ein Kooperationspartner

„Europa sucht nach Antworten auf Chinas Exportoffensive“

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 20 JUN 2026

Stéphane Séjourné (EU-Industriekommissar) gab am 20. Juni der EU maximal drei Jahre, um die eigene Industrie vor dem Druck chinesischer Einfuhren zu schützen; das EU-China-Handelsdefizit könnte bis 2027 auf 500 Milliarden Euro steigen

„Europa sucht nach Antworten auf Chinas Exportoffensive“

WELT.DE · 23 JUN 2026

Johann Wadephul (Bundesaußenminister, CDU) gab kurz vor dem 23. Juni zu Protokoll, dass eine Eskalation in der Taiwanstraße deutsche Interessen unmittelbar betreffe; für Berlin blieben Beziehungen und Geschäfte mit Peking dennoch prioritär, und man wolle sich Taipeh nicht zu stark zuwenden

„Taiwan; Totale Zerstörung – Warum dieses Szenario Europa mit am härtesten treffen würde“

WELT.DE · 23 JUN 2026

Anke Rehlinger (Ministerpräsidentin Saarland, SPD) erklärte am 23. Juni, in Saarbrücken, eine externe Untersuchung der CISA-China-Vorwürfe sei „sicherlich auch der zuverlässigste und schnellste Weg“ zur Aufklärung; beide Gesellschafter, Bund und Saarland, nähmen die Vorwürfe ernst

„Rehlinger: Vorwürfe gegen Cisa zügig aufklären“

HANDELSBLATT · 22 JUN 2026

Norbert Röttgen (CDU-Fraktionsvize, Bundestag) erklärte am 22. Juni: „Im Umgang mit China ist Naivität fehl am Platz“ und hielt es für „unabdingbar, dass staatliche Gelder, die an Universitäten oder Institute fließen, an klare Anforderungen zur Forschungssicherheit geknüpft werden“

„CHINA-KOOPERATION; CDU fordert Konsequenzen“

HANDELSBLATT · 22 JUN 2026

Florian Müller (CDU, forschungspolitischer Sprecher, Unionsbundestagsfraktion) erklärte am 22. Juni, die Situation am CISA sei inakzeptabel: „Wenn eine vom Bund finanzierte Forschungseinrichtung mutmaßlich seit vielen Jahren in hochsensiblen Feldern in großem Stil chinesische Wissenschaftler einstellt, die wohl ganze Abteilungen dominieren, dann ist das inakzeptabel“; in den vergangenen Jahren sei eine sichtbare Schieflage entstanden

„CHINA-KOOPERATION; CDU fordert Konsequenzen“

HANDELSBLATT · 24 JUN 2026

Johannes Schätzl (SPD, digitalpolitischer Sprecher, Bundestagsfraktion) drängte am 24. Juni auf eine Befassung des Digitalausschusses im Bundestag mit der CISA-Affäre; gerade in der Cybersicherheitsforschung könnten Ergebnisse „sicherheits- und verteidigungspolitische Relevanz haben“; Kooperationen mit China nahestehenden Einrichtungen bräuchten „eine umfassende Prüfung“

„CISA; China -Affäre um Helmholtz-Zentrum erreicht den Bundestag“

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 22 JUN 2026

VDA (Verband der Automobilindustrie) akzeptierte laut Stellungnahme vom 22. Juni erstmals ausdrücklich europäische Local-Content-Anforderungen als wirtschaftspolitisches Instrument und stellte fest: „Hier hat sich ein deutliches Ungleichgewicht entwickelt, das insbesondere für die automobilen Zulieferer und den industriellen Mittelstand eine erhebliche Herausforderung darstellt“ – ein deutlicher Schwenk weg von der bisherigen Freihandelsdoktrin

„Ein bisschen Abschottung, bitte“

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 22 JUN 2026

Saarländischer Verfassungsschutz erklärte am 22. Juni: „Im Saarland sind zahlreiche Forschungsinstitute ansässig, die in einer der zehn strategischen Zukunftsbranchen forschen und daher im Interesse chinesischer Nachrichtendienste stehen dürften“ – darunter CISPA, DFKI und Max-Planck-Institute; China sei bereit, Wissen auf legalem wie illegalem Weg zu beschaffen

„Inlandsgeheimdienst; Wie China Wissen aus deutscher Forschung gewinnt“

HANDELSBLATT · 22 JUN 2026

Michael Hüther (Direktor, Institut der deutschen Wirtschaft, IW) sagte am 22. Juni im Handelsblatt-Podcast: „Die preisliche Wettbewerbsfähigkeit Chinas ist eine politische“ – selbst wenn Deutschland alle wirtschaftspolitischen Hausaufgaben erledige, reiche das gegen staatlich gestützte chinesische Konkurrenz nicht aus

„PODCAST; EU sollte Zollpolitik neu denken“

WELT.DE · 20 JUN 2026

Jürgen Matthes (IW Köln, Außenhandelsexperte) erklärte am 20. Juni zur IW-Studie im Auftrag des Auswärtigen Amts: „Für den freien Handel ist Chinas Währungsmanagement Gift“ und „China spielt mit gezinkten Karten. Europa sollte mit Ausgleichszöllen für gleiche Bedingungen sorgen“; bei fairem Yuan-Kurs könnte Deutschlands BIP 2028 um bis zu 0,3 Prozent höher ausfallen

„Fairer Yuan-Kurs könnte Deutschland Milliarden bringen“

HANDELSBLATT · 22 JUN 2026

Julian Hinz (Direktor, Forschungsgruppe Handelspolitik, Kiel Institut für Weltwirtschaft) warnte am 22. Juni vor einem rein konfrontativen China-Kurs: Nur etwa ein Drittel des deutschen Marktanteilsrückgangs in Drittstaaten lasse sich auf Chinas Expansion zurückführen; Handelspolitik „ausschließlich auf die Abwehr chinesischer Konkurrenz auszurichten“ sei problematisch, da ein wesentlicher Teil der Herausforderungen hausgemacht sei

„IMPORTFLUT; Deutschlands China -Schock ist ,größtenteils hausgemacht“

FAZ.NET · 24 JUN 2026

Sander Tordoir (Chefökonom, Centre for European Reform) sagte am 24. Juni der Frankfurter Allgemeinen Zeitung, Li Qiangs Rede beim Sommer-Davos betreibe „Gaslighting“, also psychologische Manipulation; Tordoir hatte im Mai als Ko-Autor die Studie China-Schock 2.0: Die Kosten der deutschen Selbstzufriedenheit veröffentlicht, die die Debatte über unausgeglichene Handelsbeziehungen mit China stark befeuert habe

„MINISTERPRÄSIDENT LI; So wehrt sich China gegen den ‚China-Schock‘-Vorwurf“

WELT.DE · 23 JUN 2026

Francois Wu (stellvertretender Außenminister, Taiwan) erklärte am 23. Juni in Taipeh gegenüber europäischen Journalisten: China will der Welt weismachen, es gäbe ein Taiwan -Problem. Die Welt hat ein China -Problem; die fünf größten Unternehmen der Welt benötigten alle ein Produkt, das es nur in Taiwan gebe – Chips – und ein Angriff Chinas würde die Weltwirtschaft zum Absturz bringen

“Taiwan; Totale Zerstörung – Warum dieses Szenario Europa mit am härtesten treffen würde”

FAZ.NET · 23 JUN 2026

Robin Zeng (CEO, CATL) erklärte am 24. Juni, beim Sommer-Weltwirtschaftsforum in Nordostchina: „Wir wollen die Produktion von Natriumbatterien hochfahren“; CATL hatte tags zuvor in München die Pläne für das neue Batteriesystem „Tener“ vorgestellt und bezeichnete Lithium und Natrium als zwei Pfeiler der Energiespeicherung der Zukunft; 95 Prozent der globalen Produktionskapazitäten für Natriumbatterien liegen in China

“CHINAS SALZBATTERIE; CATL kommt Varta zuvor”

HANDELSBLATT · 25 JUN 2026

Ralf Brandstätter (CEO, Volkswagen China) sagte am 25. Juni am Rande des Sommer-Davos in Dalian: „Die Innovationsgeschwindigkeit in China ist in vielen Technologiefeldern extrem hoch“ – dies führe dazu, Strategien in China zu entwickeln, die dann für andere Märkte genutzt werden könnten

“LI QIANG; Chinas Premier weist Vorwürfe zurück”

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 25 JUN 2026

Arran Hope (China-Experte, Jamestown Foundation) sagte am 25. Juni dem Handelsblatt: „Dass Kooperationen trotz militärnahe Bezüge und Dual-Use-Risiken weiterlaufen, ist aus meiner Sicht kontraproduktiv“ – der persönliche Austausch mit China bleibe gleichwohl „von unschätzbarem Wert“; besonders in MINT-Fächern und technologisch sensiblen Feldern seien Kooperationen ein wachsendes Risiko

“Sicherheit; Warum Chinas Forschungsmodell Risiken für Deutschland birgt”

BILD PLUS · 23 JUN 2026

Adrian Geiges (Journalist, Autor der Xi-Jinping-Biografie) warnte am 23. Juni: „Wir schlafwandeln in ein chinesisches Zeitalter. Es ist fünf vor zwölf“ – Xi verbinde kommunistische Ideologie mit chinesischem Nationalismus, das strategische Ziel sei die Abhängigkeit des Auslands von China; die Energiewende wiederhole den Fehler der Gas-Abhängigkeit von Russland, diesmal mit China

“China -Experte Adrian Geiges warnt; ‚Wir schlafwandeln in ein chinesisches Zeitalter‘”

TAZ - DIE TAGESZEITUNG · 26 JUN 2026

Michael Backes (Wissenschaftlicher Geschäftsführer, CISPA, freigestellt) verteidigte sich auf LinkedIn bis zum 26. Juni: Lange gab es keinen klaren gesellschaftlichen oder politischen Konsens im Umgang mit China, oftmals sogar widersprüchliche Linien; sein Institut habe sich stets auf der vorsichtigen Seite bewegt und begrüße die Sonderprüfung „im Interesse einer lückenlosen Aufklärung“

“Verdacht auf Wissenschaftsspionage”

HANDELSBLATT · 22 JUN 2026

Bert Rürup (Chefökonom, Handelsblatt) erklärte am 22. Juni im Podcast: „Das traditionelle Geschäftsmodell bricht zusammen, der Alterungsschub hat eingesetzt und die demokratischen Parteien verlieren an Stärke“ – Deutschland stecke in einer Multikrise, aus der auch eine Korrektur der China-Handelspolitik allein nicht herausführe

“PODCAST; EU sollte Zollpolitik neu denken”

HANDELSBLATT · 22 JUN 2026

Peter Felser (AfD, MdB) warnte am 22. Juni vor falschen Konsequenzen aus dem CISPA-Fall: Nun ausschließlich auf Abschottung zu setzen und jede Kooperation mit China pauschal abzulehnen, ist für unseren ohnehin schwächelnden Technologiestandort keine Lösung und stellte sich damit gegen den parteiübergreifenden Tenor der schärferen Forschungssicherheitsregeln

“CHINA-KOOPERATION; CDU fordert Konsequenzen”

2. Wichtige China-bezogene Entwicklungen in Fakten und Zahlen

HANDELSBLATT · 25 JUN 2026

Chinas Leistungsbilanzüberschuss auf Rekordniveau: Der chinesische Leistungsbilanzüberschuss stieg 2025 auf rund ****735 Milliarden US-Dollar**** – das entspricht 3,7 Prozent der Wirtschaftsleistung.

“Die EU sollte Chinas unfaire Währungspolitik kontern”

HANDELSBLATT · 25 JUN 2026

Yuan strukturell unterbewertet: Chinas Währung dürfte aktuell um bis zu ****30 Prozent**** unter ihrem fairen Wert liegen – nach anerkannter IWF-Methodik ergibt sich eine Unterbewertung von schätzungsweise 19 bis 30 Prozent.

“Die EU sollte Chinas unfaire Währungspolitik kontern”

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 20 JUN 2026

EU-Handelsbilanzdefizit mit China könnte explodieren: Das EU-Handelsdefizit gegenüber China liegt bereits bei einer Milliarde Euro am Tag und könnte bis 2027 auf ****500 Milliarden Euro**** steigen.

“Europa sucht nach Antworten auf Chinas Exportoffensive”

HANDELSBLATT · 25 JUN 2026

Deutsches Handelsbilanzdefizit auf Rekord: Das deutsche Handelsbilanzdefizit gegenüber China ist auf rund ****90 Milliarden Euro**** explodiert – getrieben durch die währungsbedingte Kostenverzerrung.

“Die EU sollte Chinas unfaire Währungspolitik kontern”

WELT.DE · 23 JUN 2026

China dominiert globalen Solarausbau: In der Volksrepublik wurden 2025 neue Solarkraftwerke mit einer Leistung von knapp ****382 Gigawatt**** installiert – das entspricht ****72 Prozent**** der weltweit neu zugebauten Kapazitäten.

“Deutschland rückt global auf Platz vier des Solarausbaus”

DER TAGESSPIEGEL · 23 JUN 2026

Chinas Windkraftzubau übertrifft Deutschlands Gesamtbestand: China installierte 2025 ****78 Gigawatt**** Windenergie neu – so viel wie alle in Deutschland bereits installierten Windräder zusammengekommen.

“Weltweit starker Ausbau von Solarenergie und Batteriespeichern”

FAZ.NET · 22 JUN 2026

China kontrolliert Permanentmagnet-Markt: Für Permanentmagnete, die in Elektroautos, Windkraftanlagen und Rüstungsgütern verbaut werden, liegt Chinas Weltmarktanteil laut Internationaler Energieagentur bei nahezu ****95 Prozent****.

“China schlägt nach US-Sanktionen zurück”

FAZ.NET · 23 JUN 2026

China hält 95 Prozent der globalen Batterie-Produktionskapazitäten: Fast alle existierenden globalen Fertigungskapazitäten für Batterien stehen in China; der Anteil an bestehenden oder bis 2030 angekündigten Fabriken liegt bei ****95 Prozent****. CATL plant eine Jahreskapazität von über ****1.000 Gigawattstunden****.

“CATL kommt Varta zuvor”

HANDELSBLATT · 22 JUN 2026

BYD und Chery legen bei EU-Plug-ins massiv zu: Die EU-Zulassungen von BYD bei Plug-in-Hybriden stiegen in den ersten fünf Monaten 2026 um ****260 Prozent****; der Hersteller Chery steigerte seine Plug-in-Auslieferungen sogar um ****668 Prozent****.

“EU bereitet Zölle auf chinesische Plug-ins vor”

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE SONNTAGSZEITUNG · 21 JUN 2026

BMW streicht 3 Milliarden Euro Gewinn wegen China: Wegen anhaltender Einbußen im chinesischen Markt wird BMW 2026 rund ****3 Milliarden Euro**** weniger verdienen als geplant; die operative Gewinnmarge im Autogeschäft sinkt auf nur noch 1 bis 3 Prozent.

“Der BMW-Schock”

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 24 JUN 2026

Audi-Absatz in China bricht ein: Die Zulassungen von Audi in China sind seit Januar 2026 um rund ****14 Prozent**** gesunken; der Konzern prüft, sein mittelfristiges Absatzziel von 2,2 auf unter 2 Millionen Fahrzeuge zu senken.

“Audi stellt Absatzziele infrage”

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 25 JUN 2026

China kauft systematisch deutsche Patente: Von den 650.000 internationalen Patenten deutscher Unternehmen (2000–2022) wurden allein ****11.300** von chinesischen Unternehmen aufgekauft^{**}; Midea kündigte an, in drei Jahren ****8,7 Milliarden Euro**** in KI und Robotik zu investieren – so viel wie in den fünf Jahren davor zusammen.

“Wie Deutschland sein Wissen nach China verkauft”

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 22 JUN 2026

WeChat als KI-Betriebssystem für 1,3 Milliarden Nutzer: Tencent integriert KI-Agenten in WeChat, das laut Konzernangaben mehr als ****1,3 Milliarden**** Nutzer zählt – und damit zur zentralen Plattform für Chinas staatliche KI-Strategie werden soll.

“Wechat soll zum KI-Betriebssystem der Chinesen werden”

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 22 JUN 2026

Chinas Mindestrente für Landbewohner: 21 Euro im Monat: Die Regierung erhöhte die Mindestrente für Landbewohner um 20 Yuan – auf umgerechnet knapp ****21 Euro**** im Monat. Betroffen sind rund ****180 Millionen**** Menschen, mehrheitlich Bauern.

“Zwanzigfache Rente für Chinas Stadtbewohner”

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 22 JUN 2026

Chinas Zentralbank hält Leitzins 13 Monate unverändert: Die People's Bank of China beließ den einjährigen Referenzzins (LPR) zum ****13. Monat in Folge**** bei ****3,00 Prozent****, den fünfjährigen bei 3,50 Prozent – trotz schwacher Binnennachfrage und anhaltender Immobilienkrise.

“China belässt Leitzinsen den 13. Monat in Folge unverändert”

3. Fünf zentrale Themen in der deutschen China-Politik Diskussion

CISPA-Affäre: Chinas Zugriff auf deutsche Forschungseinrichtungen

Das Handelsblatt deckte auf, dass das Helmholtz-Zentrum für Informationssicherheit CISPA in Saarbrücken eng mit chinesischen Wissenschaftlern kooperiert hatte, die zugleich Verbindungen zu militärischen Einrichtungen in China unterhielten; der Bund setzte daraufhin einen Sonderprüfer ein und enthob den Zentrumsdirektor vorläufig. Die Süddeutsche Zeitung erweiterte die Debatte um eine IW-Studie, der zufolge von 650.000 deutschen Patentanmeldungen zwischen 2000 und 2022 rund 11.300 von chinesischen Unternehmen aufgekauft wurden. Beide Stränge – Spionageverdacht und struktureller Wissensabfluss – verdichteten sich in der taz zu einem Gesamtbild systemischer Verwundbarkeit deutscher Forschungseinrichtungen gegenüber chinesischem Zugriff.

PROMINENTE QUELLEN

HANDELSBLATT · 22 JUN 2026 *“Wie China Wissen aus deutscher Forschung gewinnt”*

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 25 JUN 2026 *“Wie Deutschland sein Wissen nach China verkauft”*

TAZ · 26 JUN 2026 *“Verdacht auf Wissenschaftsspionage”*

China-Schock 2.0: EU-Zölle, Handelsdefizit und Lieferkettenpolitik

Der EU-Gipfel in Brüssel markierte eine Kehrtwende in der europäischen China-Handelspolitik: Die Kommission kündigte ein Gesetz zur Lieferkettendiversifizierung an, mit dem Unternehmen per Gesetz zu breiterer Lieferantenstreuung verpflichtet werden sollen. Parallel bereitet die EU Ausgleichszölle auf chinesische Plug-in-Hybride vor; Industriekommissar Séjourné gab der EU maximal drei Jahre, um die eigene Industrie vor dem Importdruck zu schützen – das Handelsdefizit gegenüber China könnte 2027 auf 500 Milliarden Euro steigen. Ökonomen stritten zugleich darüber, ob ein um bis zu 30 Prozent unterbewerteter Yuan strukturell für Europas Wettbewerbsnachteile mitverantwortlich ist oder ob Deutschlands Verluste primär hausgemacht sind.

PROMINENTE QUELLEN

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 20 JUN 2026 *“Europa sucht nach Antworten auf Chinas Exportoffensive”*

HANDELSBLATT · 22 JUN 2026 *“EU bereitet Zölle auf chinesische Plug-ins vor”*

ZEIT · 20 JUN 2026 *“EU plant Vorgaben für geringere wirtschaftliche Abhängigkeit von China”*

KI-Souveränität: Europas Reaktion auf die Anthropic-Sperre

Die kurzfristige Sperrung von Anthropics neuesten KI-Modellen für Nicht-US-Nutzer löste medienübergreifend die Debatte aus, ob Europa beim Zugang zu strategisch entscheidender KI dauerhaft abgehängt werden kann. FAS und Welt sahen darin den Beweis, dass Washington KI wie eine strategische Waffe behandelt – mit dem Risiko, dass dieser Zustand zum Dauerzustand wird. Das Handelsblatt forderte eine „KI-Zeitenwende“ analog zur Verteidigungsaufrüstung; parallel warf Anthropic dem chinesischen Alibaba-Konzern vor, systematisch Modell-Fähigkeiten widerrechtlich abzugreifen – was den China-Bezug der Technologiesouveränitätsdebatte zusätzlich schärfte.

PROMINENTE QUELLEN

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE SONNTAGSZEITUNG · 21 JUN 2026 *“Europas Ausweg aus der KI-Falle”*

WELT · 20 JUN 2026 *“Anthropic-Schock; Europa sucht den Ausweg aus Amerikas KI-Falle”*

WIRTSCHAFTSWOCHE · 20 JUN 2026 *“Technologiepolitik ist inzwischen globale Machtpolitik”*

Deutschlands Industriekrise und Chinas Innovationsvorsprung im Automobil

BMW's drastische Gewinnwarnung – rund drei Milliarden Euro weniger als prognostiziert – steht exemplarisch für eine Branche, die im Wettbewerb mit China den Anschluss verliert. Die FAZ argumentiert, China sei für die globale Automobilindustrie zum „Fitnesscenter für Innovation“ geworden: Beim KI-definierten Automobil habe das Land Maßstäbe gesetzt, die Europa zur Positionierung zwingen. Das Handelsblatt hingegen warnte, Deutschlands Marktanteilsverluste überstiegen das, was allein durch staatlich subventionierte Importe erklärt werden kann – der „China-Schock“ sei damit auch ein selbstverschuldetes Wettbewerbsproblem.

PROMINENTE QUELLEN

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE SONNTAGSZEITUNG · 21 JUN 2026 *“Der BMW-Schock”*

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 24 JUN 2026 *“China als Fitnesscenter für Innovation”*

HANDELSBLATT · 22 JUN 2026 *“Deutschlands China-Schock ist 'größtenteils hausgemacht’”*

Chinas geopolitische Expansionsstrategie: Taiwan-Risiko, Iran-Krieg und Myanmar

Die Welt warnte, ein chinesischer Angriff auf Taiwan würde Europa wegen der globalen Halbleiterabhängigkeit von der Insel wirtschaftlich und sicherheitspolitisch am härtesten treffen – und kritisierte westliches Beschwichtigungskalkül gegenüber Peking. Der Tagesspiegel berichtete, Chinas Militäranalytiker werteten den US-Einsatz im Iran systematisch aus, um konkrete Erkenntnisse für einen möglichen künftigen Konflikt um Taiwan zu gewinnen. Gleichzeitig empfing Xi Jinping Myanmars Militärjunta-Chef Min Aung Hlaing zu einem Staatsbesuch und half ihm, die internationale Isolation seit dem Putsch von 2021 zu durchbrechen – ein Zeichen, wie aktiv Peking globale Konstellationen zu seinen Gunsten gestaltet.

PROMINENTE QUELLEN

WELT · 23 JUN 2026

“Taiwan; Totale Zerstörung – Warum dieses Szenario Europa mit am härtesten treffen würde”

DER TAGESSPIEGEL · 24 JUN 2026 *“Chinas Führung beobachtet den Iran-Krieg – und lernt”*

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 23 JUN 2026

“Myanmars Rückkehr; China hilft dem Militärmachthaber fünf Jahre nach dem Putsch aus der Isolation”